Nexora property management

Step-by-step guide: a tenancy from setting up a property to the tenant moving out, as the landlord and in the tenant app

Screens captured 30 Oct 2026 · 49 steps · Nexora (local demo environment)

Before you start

Links

What	Link
Landlord: your normal browser window	`http://localhost:3000/register` to sign up, `http://localhost:3000/login` next time
Tenant app: use a private / incognito window, or a phone	`http://localhost:3000/portal`, reached through the invitation email first
Email inbox: catches every email the app sends	`http://localhost:8025`

Use a new email for yourself as the landlord and a different one for the tenant (e.g. *wanjiku@test.com*). Any made-up address works, because every email lands in the inbox above.

Dates: the lease starts on **1 Sept 2026** (the 1st of last month), so you bill **September 2026** and **October 2026**. The move-out happens today, **30 Oct 2026**.

Money used throughout

Item	KES
Monthly rent + security charge	22,000 + 1,500 = 23,500
Billed for two months	47,000
Deposit received	22,000
Cash payment	30,000 → balance 17,000
Damage found at move-out	3,000
Deposit used to clear the balance	17,000
Refund to the tenant	2,000

Reading this guide

LANDLORD steps happen in the landlord window; **TENANT APP** steps in the private window or phone.

marks the button to press.

Contents

1 Sign up
2 Property and units
3 Tenant and lease
4 The tenant joins the tenant app
5 Payment method, charges and billing
6 Deposit, payment and receipt
7 Announcement
8 A repair reported in the tenant app
9 Moving out: the notice
10 Moving out: the inspection
11 Moving out: settlement
12 The end state
13 Every tab in the landlord dashboard
14 Tenants moving in mid-month

For the demo

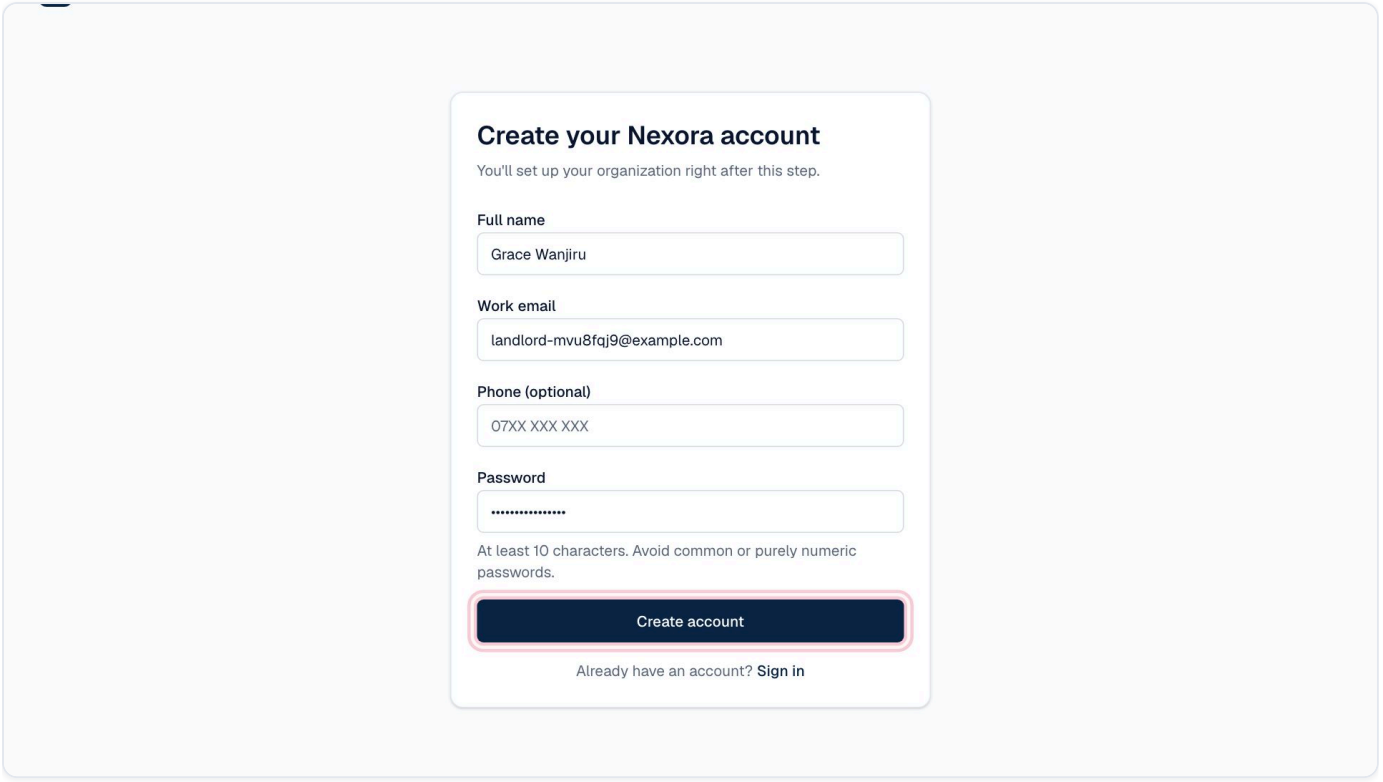
Show the tenant app at phone size: in the tenant window press ⌥⌘I (Windows: F12), click the phone icon and pick a phone. On a real phone, the app can be added to the home screen and opens like any other app.

1 Sign up

The landlord creates an account and their organization. Everything else lives inside it.

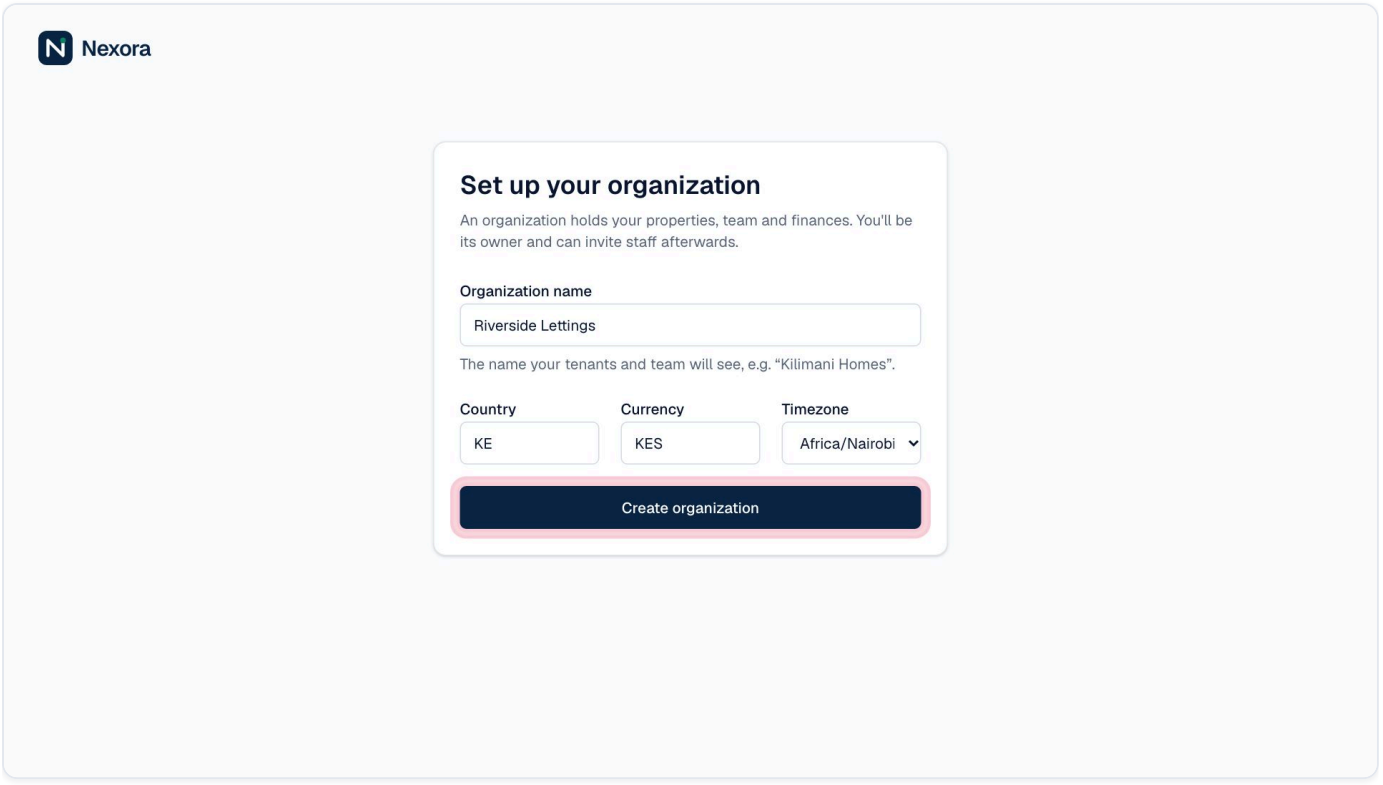
1 LANDLORD

Open **http://localhost:3000/register**. Enter your **Full name**, **Work email** and a **Password**, then click **Create account**.



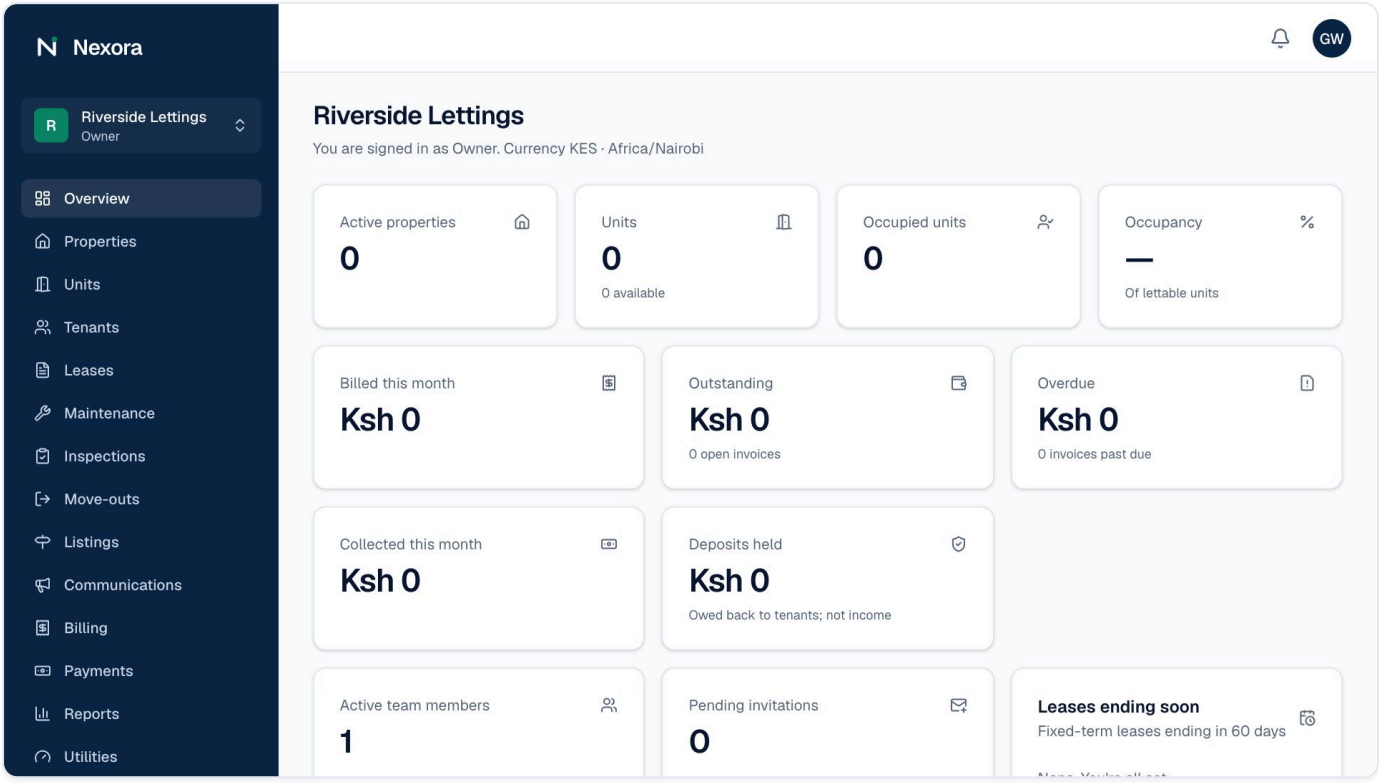
2 LANDLORD

Enter your **Organization name** (e.g. *Riverside Lettings*) and click **Create organization**. Kenya, KES and the Nairobi time zone are the defaults.



3 LANDLORD

You land on the dashboard. The sidebar lists everything you can manage; it shows only what your role is allowed to use.

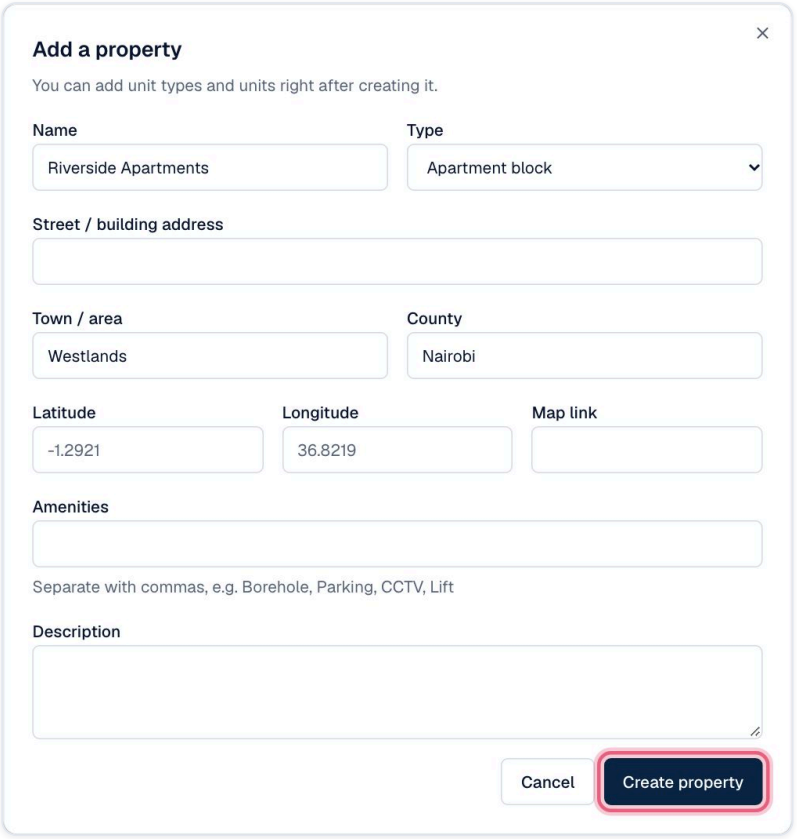


2 Property and units

A property holds unit types (the kinds of home, with their default rent and deposit) and the units themselves.

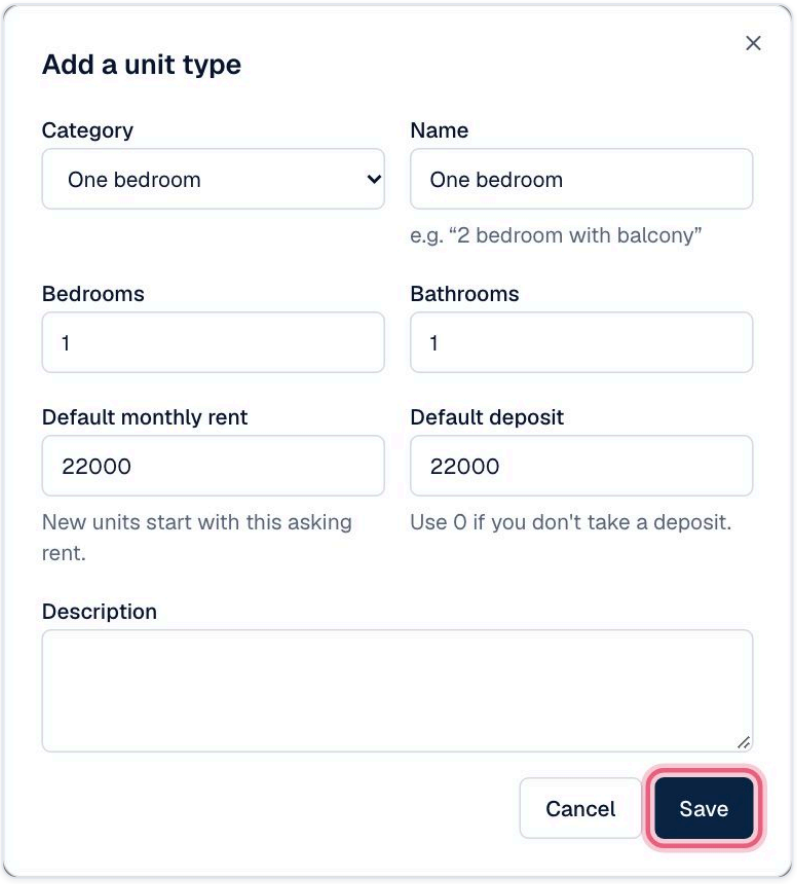
4 **LANDLORD**

Sidebar **Properties** → **Add property**. Name *Riverside Apartments*, Town / area *Westlands*, County *Nairobi* → **Create property**.



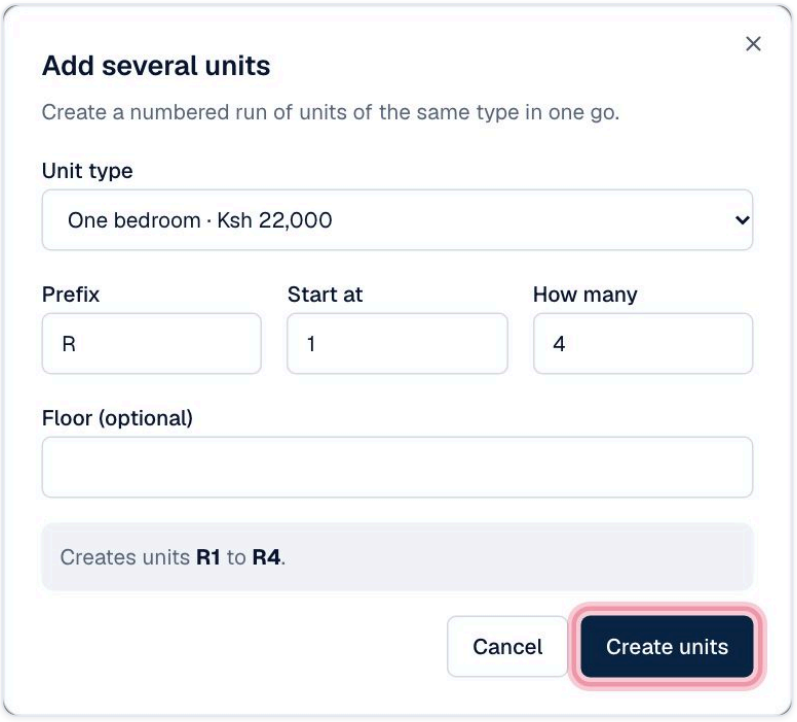
5 LANDLORD

On the property page open the **Unit types** tab → **Add unit type**. Category *One bedroom*, Default monthly rent *22000*, Default deposit *22000* → **Save**.



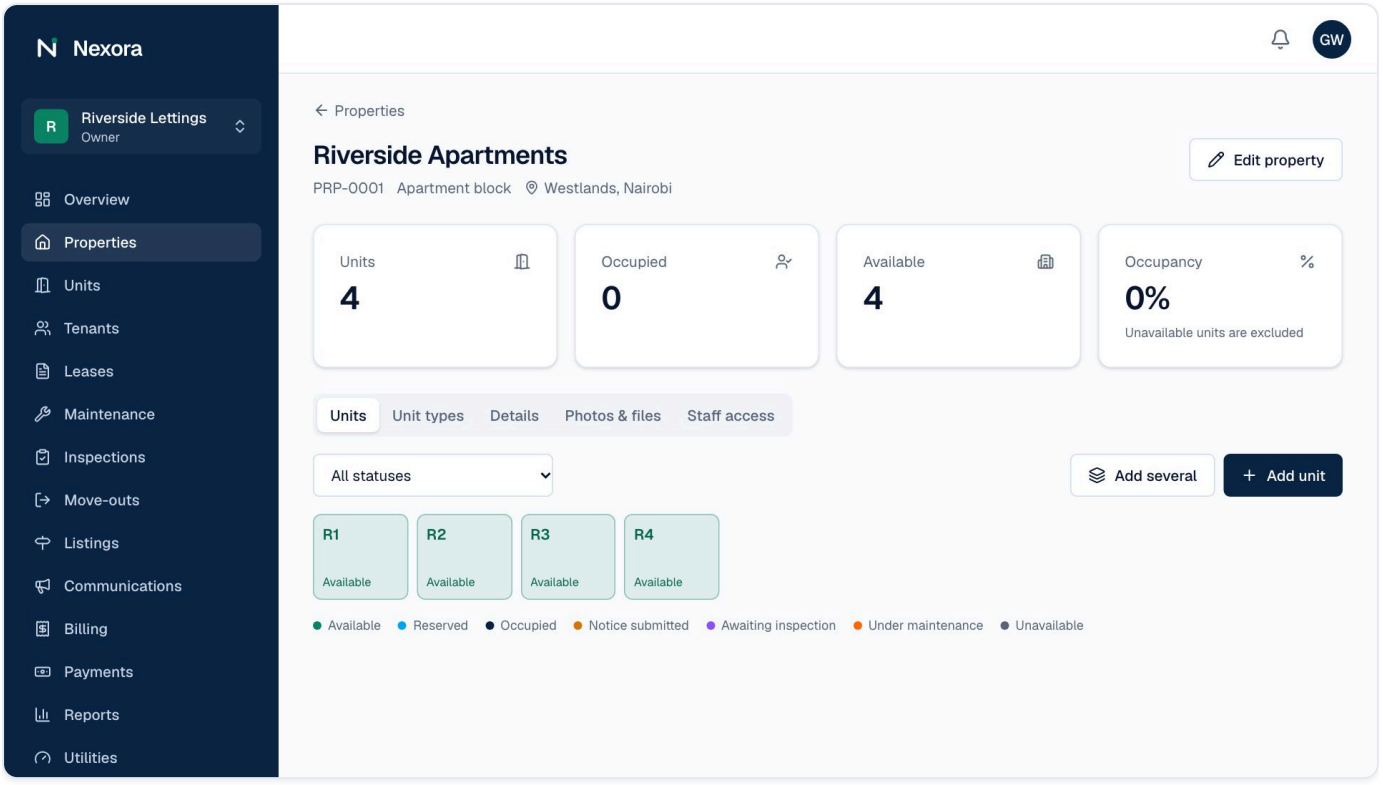
6 LANDLORD

Open the **Units** tab → **Add several**. Prefix *R*, How many *4*. The dialog previews the unit numbers → **Create units**.



7 **LANDLORD**

Units R1 to R4 appear in the grid, all **Available**. Click a unit to change its status by hand (e.g. under maintenance).

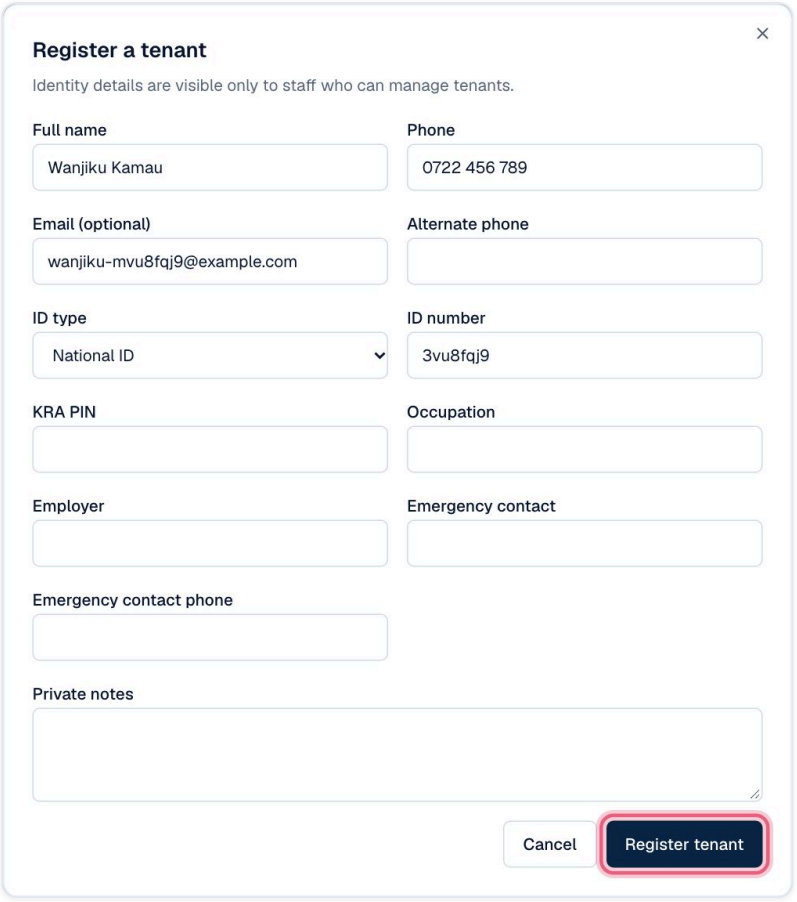


3 Tenant and lease

Register the tenant, then let a unit to them. The lease holds the rent, deposit, billing frequency and due day.

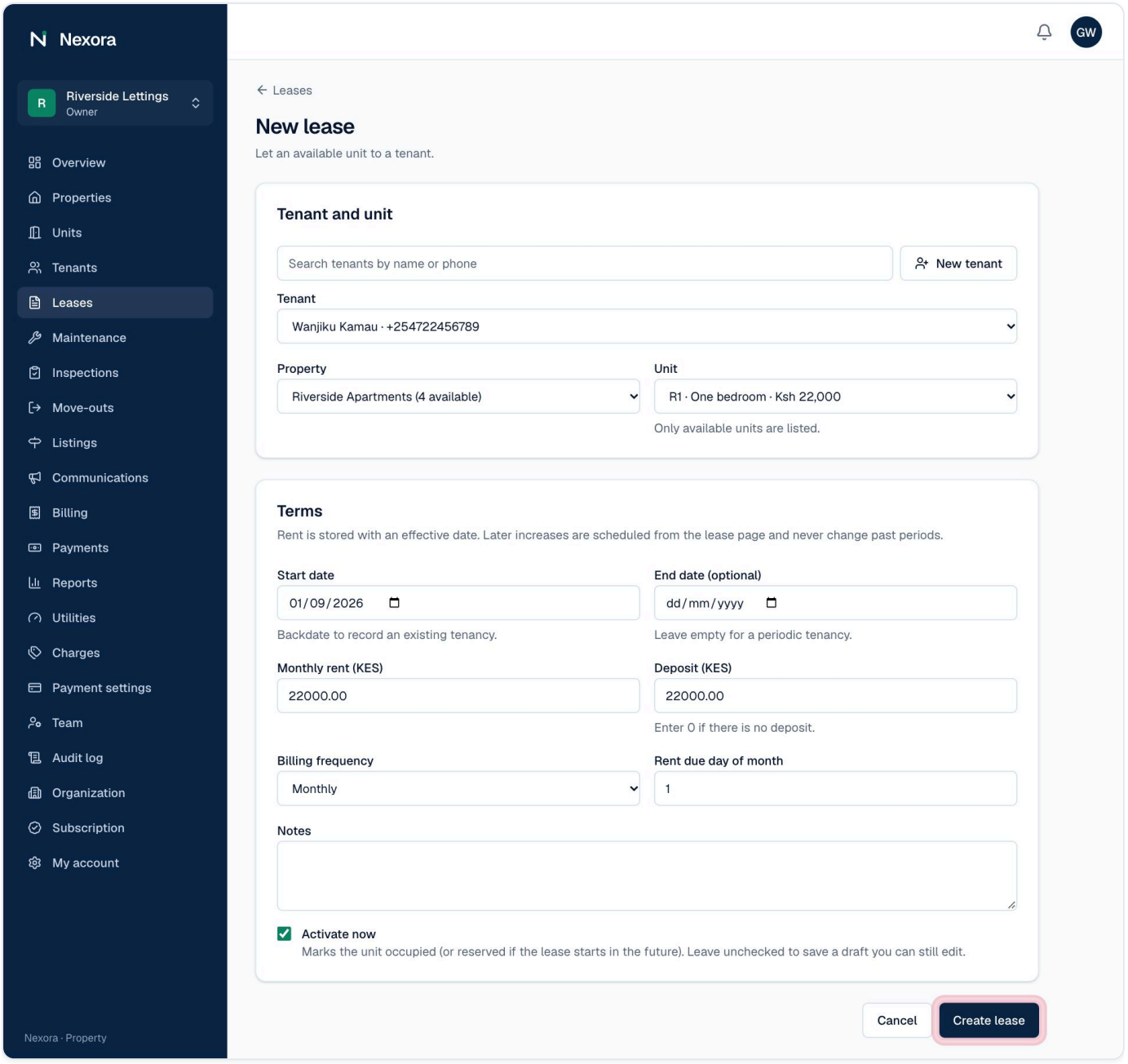
8 LANDLORD

Sidebar **Tenants** → **Register tenant**. Full name *Wanjiku Kamau*, Phone *0722 456 789*, her **email** (needed for the tenant app), any ID number → **Register tenant**.



9 **LANDLORD**

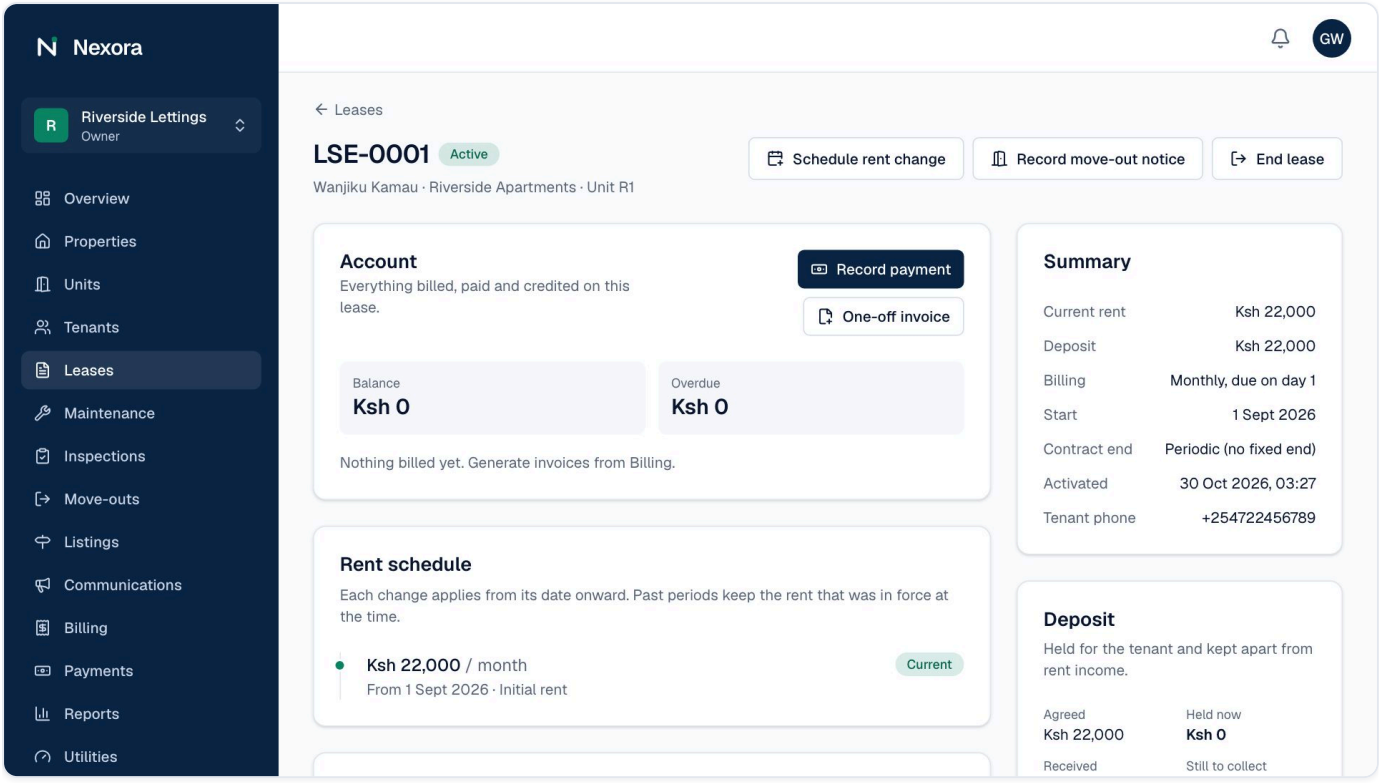
On her page choose **New lease**. Property *Riverside Apartments*, Unit *R1*: rent and deposit fill in from the unit type. Set **Start date** to **1 Sept 2026** → **Create lease**.



10 **LANDLORD**

The lease **LSE-0001** is **Active** and R1 is now **Occupied**. The lease page is the tenant's account: balance, bills, deposit and payments.

> Moving in part-way through a month? See **Tenants moving in mid-month** at the end of this guide.

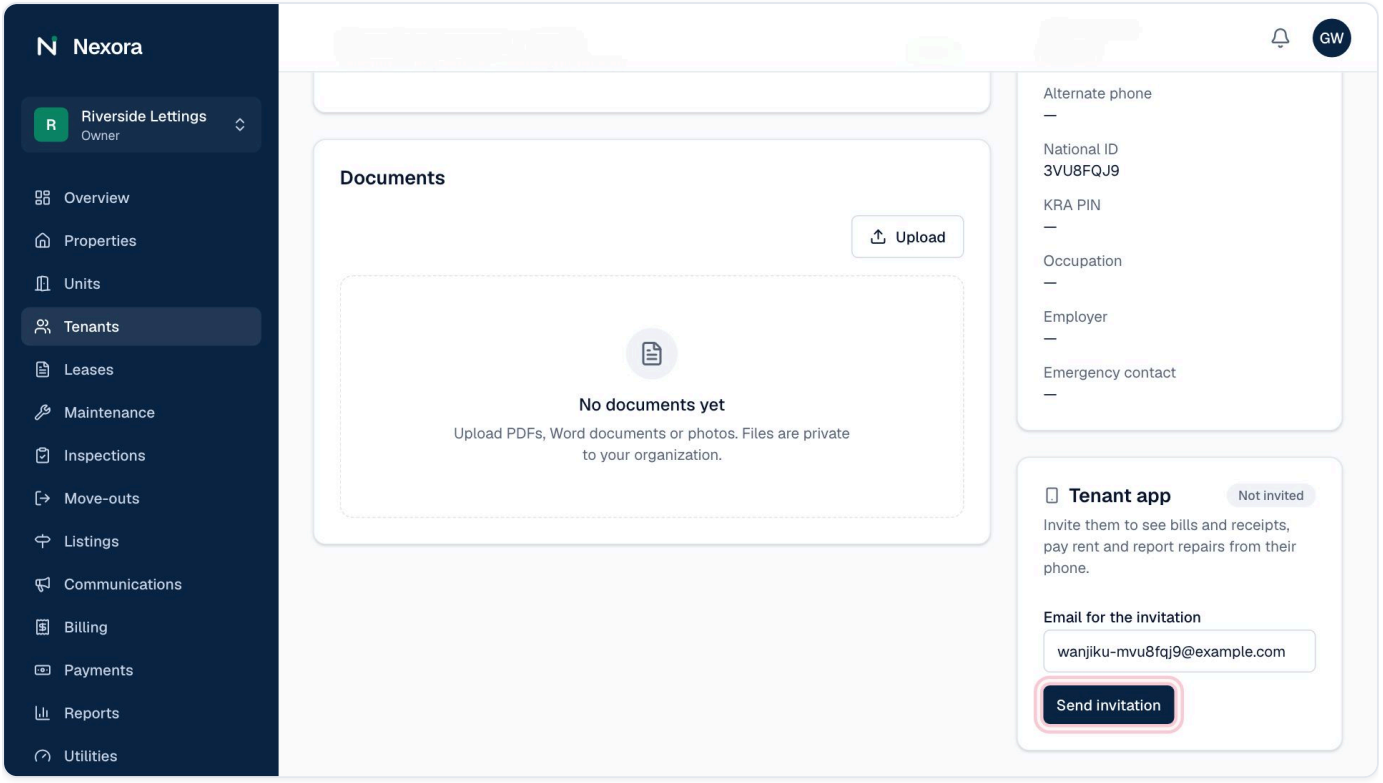


4 The tenant joins the tenant app

Tenants get their own app for their bills, receipts, payments, repairs and moving out. They join from an email invitation.

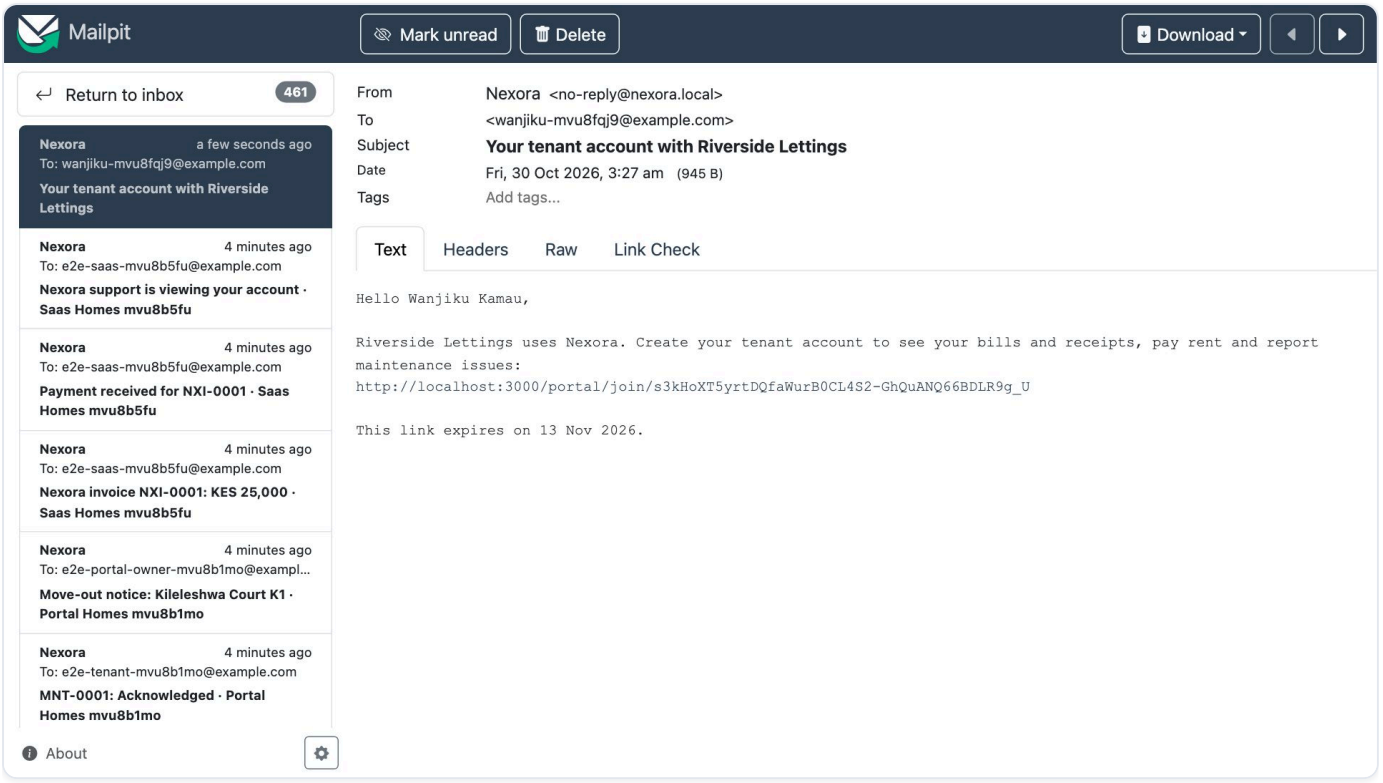
11 **LANDLORD**

On Wanjiku's page, the **Tenant app** card says **Not invited**. Check the email and click **Send invitation**. The badge changes to **Invited**.



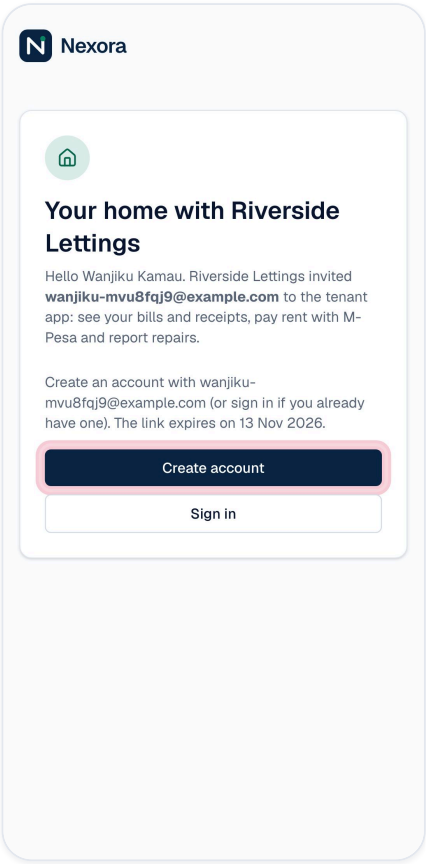
12 EMAIL INBOX

Open the inbox at **http://localhost:8025** and open *Your tenant account with Riverside Lettings*. Copy the link. (In production this goes to the tenant's real email; the link lasts 14 days.)



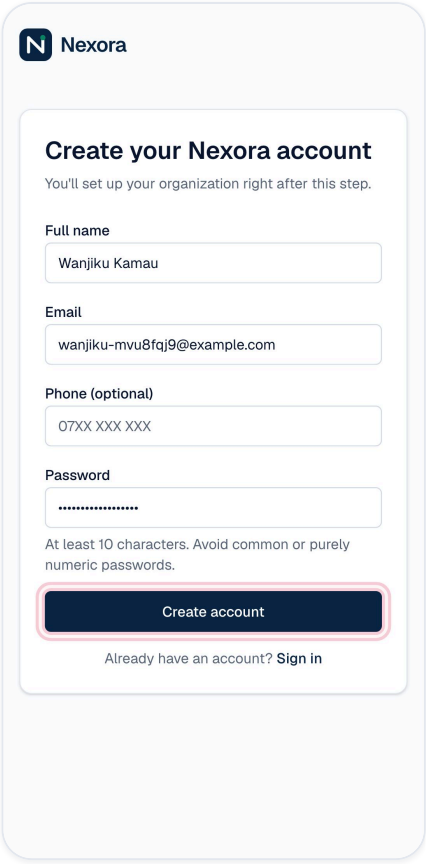
13 TENANT APP

In a **private window** (or on a phone), open the link. It shows who invited her → **Create account**.



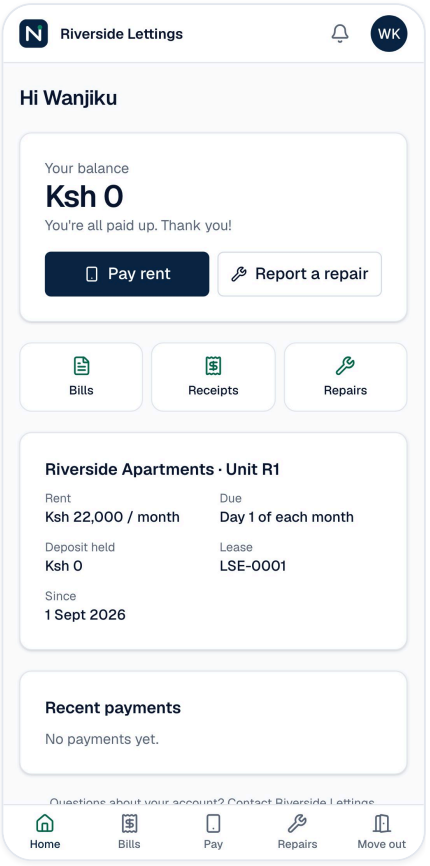
14 TENANT APP

Enter her **Full name** and a **Password**; the email is filled in → **Create account**, then **Open my home**.



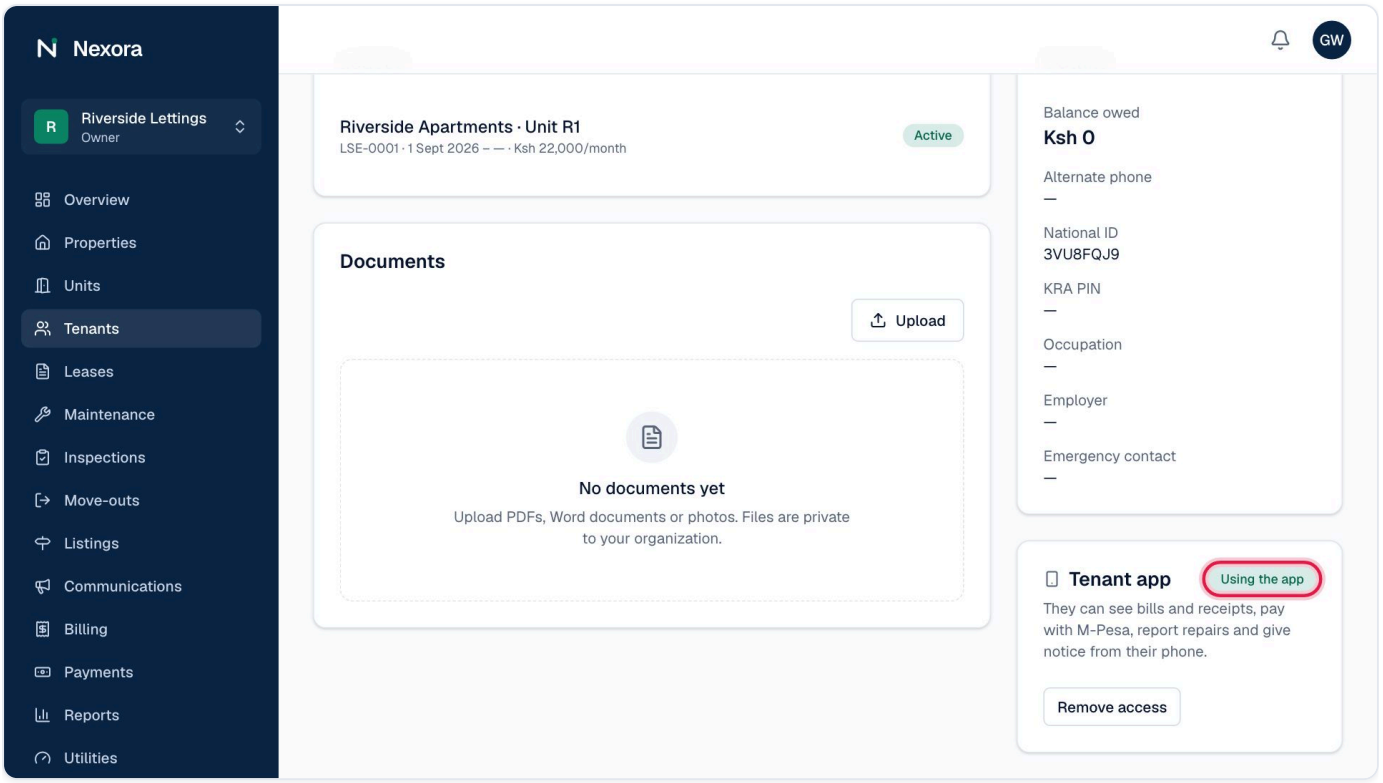
15 TENANT APP

The tenant app: *Hi Wanjiku*, her home and a balance of 0. On a phone it offers to install itself (Android: **Install app**; iPhone: Share → **Add to Home Screen**).



16 **LANDLORD**

Refresh Wanjiku's page: the badge now says **Using the app**. From here you can also remove her access.

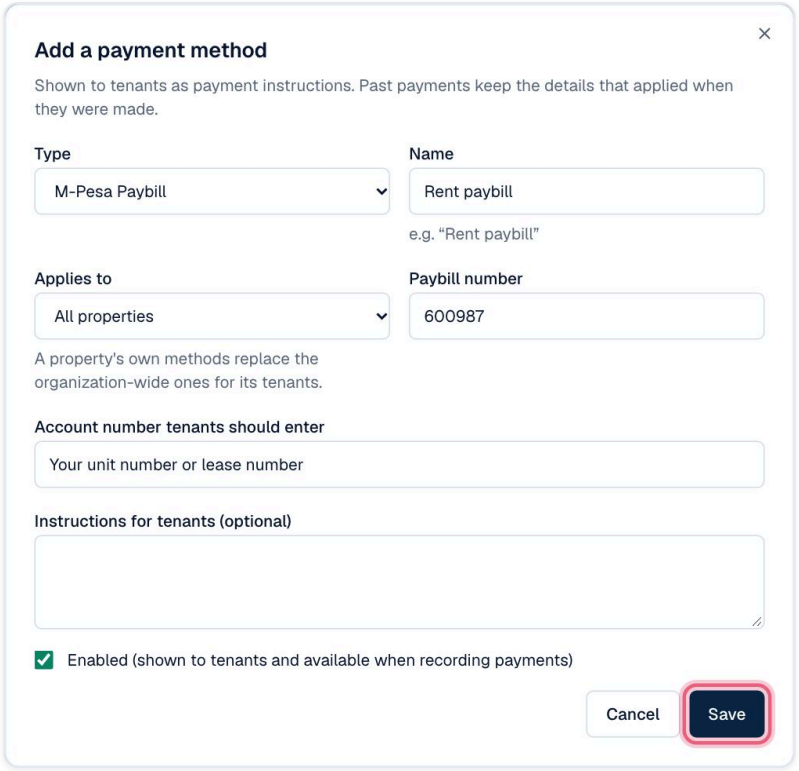


5 Payment method, charges and billing

Tell tenants how to pay, add extra charges, then bill each month. Billing previews everything before posting.

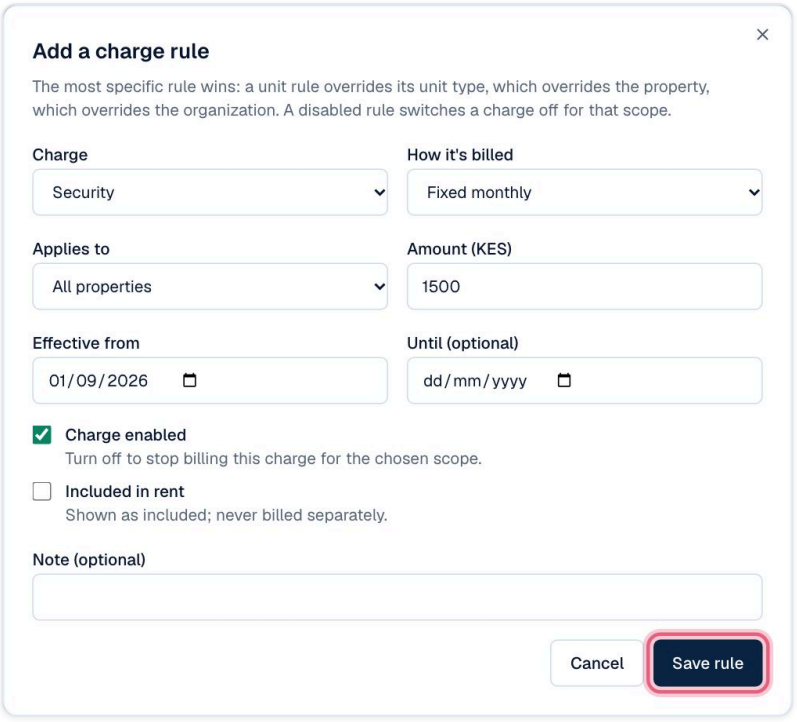
17 LANDLORD

Sidebar **Payment settings** → **Add payment method**. Type *M-Pesa paybill*, Name *Rent paybill*, Paybill number *600987* → **Save**. Tenants see these details, with their own account number, in the app.



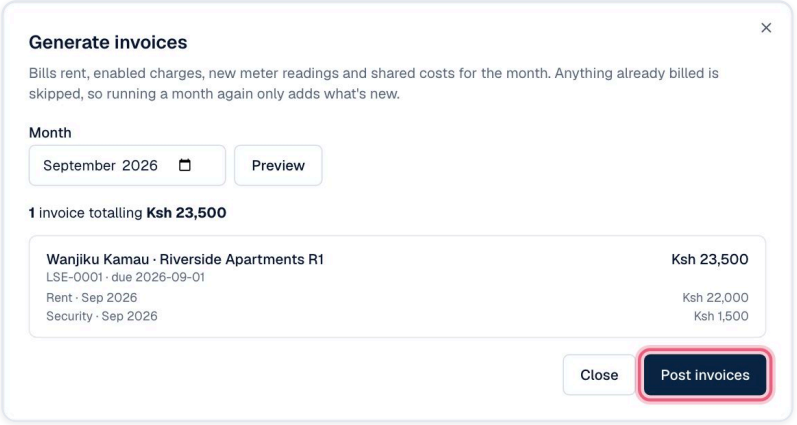
18 LANDLORD

Sidebar **Charges** → **Add rule**. Charge *Security*, Amount *1500*, Effective from *1 Sept 2026* → **Save rule**. It applies to every unit unless you make an exception.



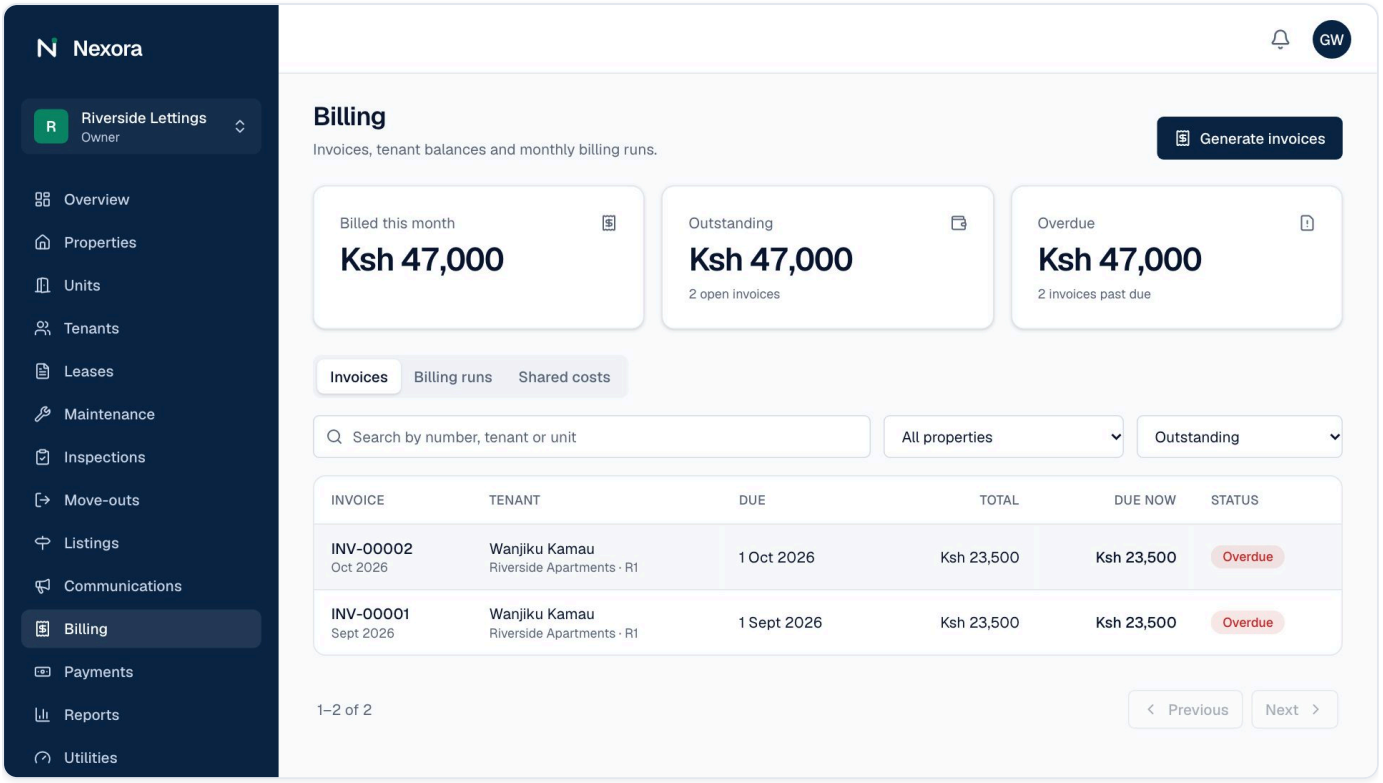
19 LANDLORD

Sidebar **Billing** → **Generate invoices**. Month **September 2026** → **Preview**: *1 invoice totalling Ksh 23,500* (rent 22,000 + security 1,500) → **Post invoices**. Repeat for **October 2026**.



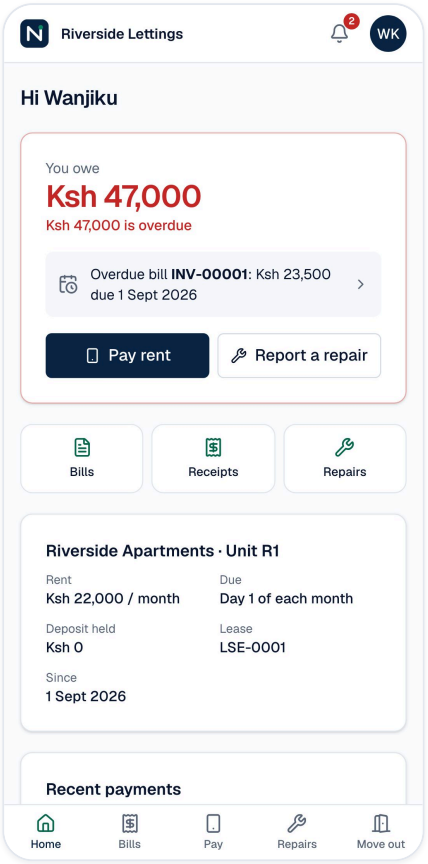
20 LANDLORD

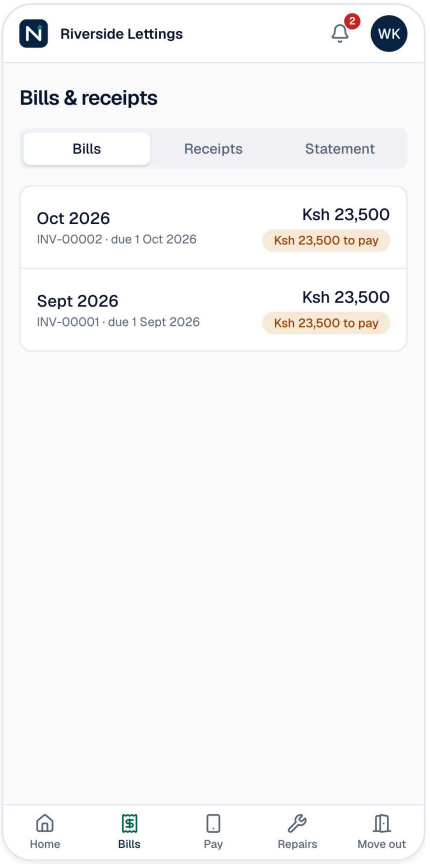
The billing list shows both invoices. Running a month again only bills what's new, so nothing is ever billed twice.



21 TENANT APP

Refresh the tenant app: **You owe Ksh 47,000**, with the overdue amount in red. **Bills** lists both bills; tap one to see its lines.

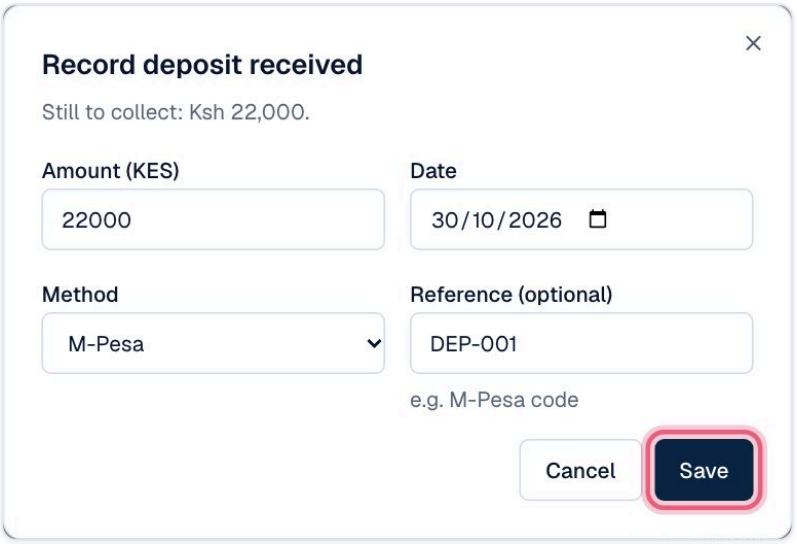




6 Deposit, payment and receipt

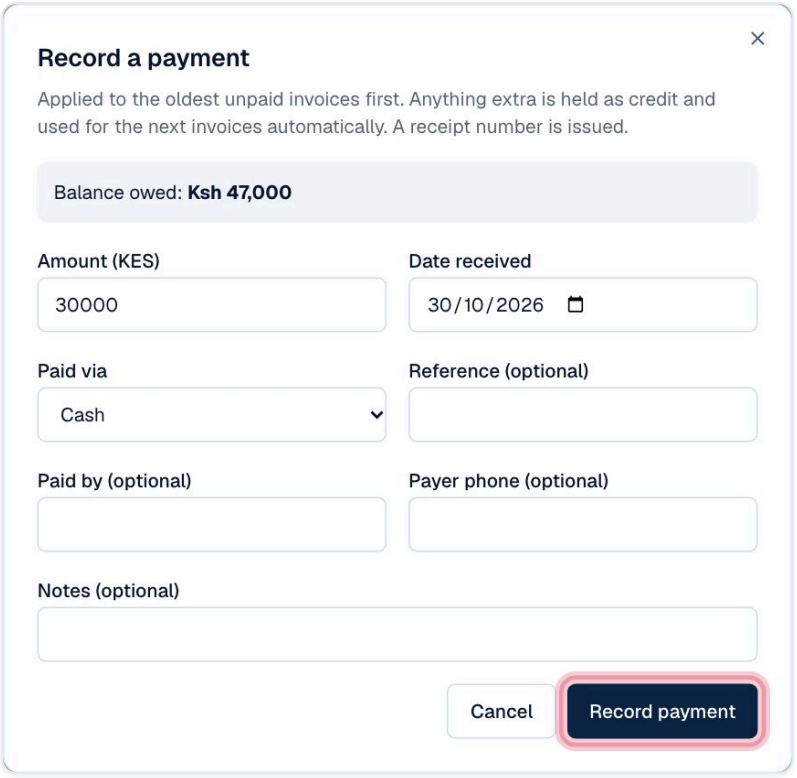
22 LANDLORD

On the lease page (**Leases** → **LSE-0001**), in the deposit card, click **Record received**. Amount *22000*, Reference *DEP-001* → **Save**. The deposit is held separately: it isn't added to what the tenant owes.



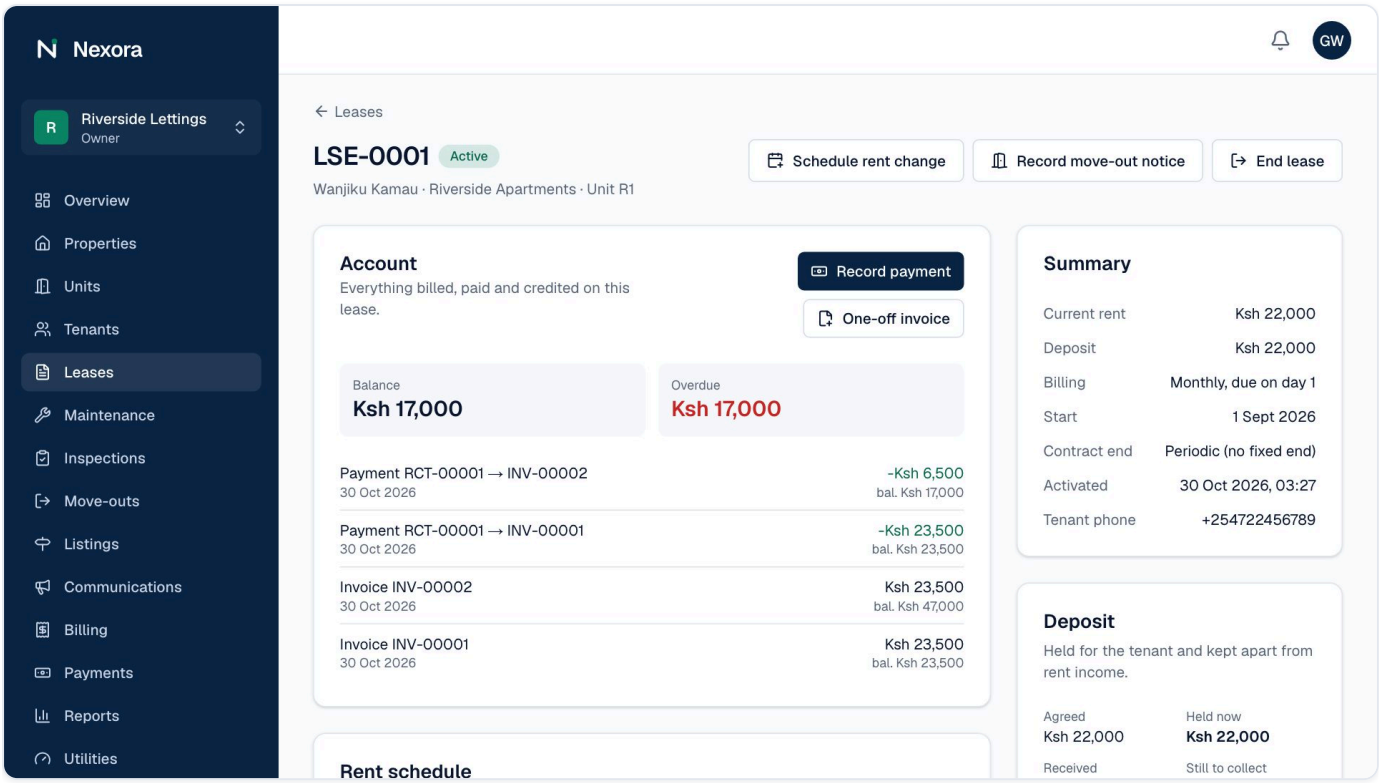
23 LANDLORD

Click **Record payment**. Amount *30000*, Paid via *Cash* → **Record payment**. A receipt (RCT-00001) is issued and the tenant is notified.



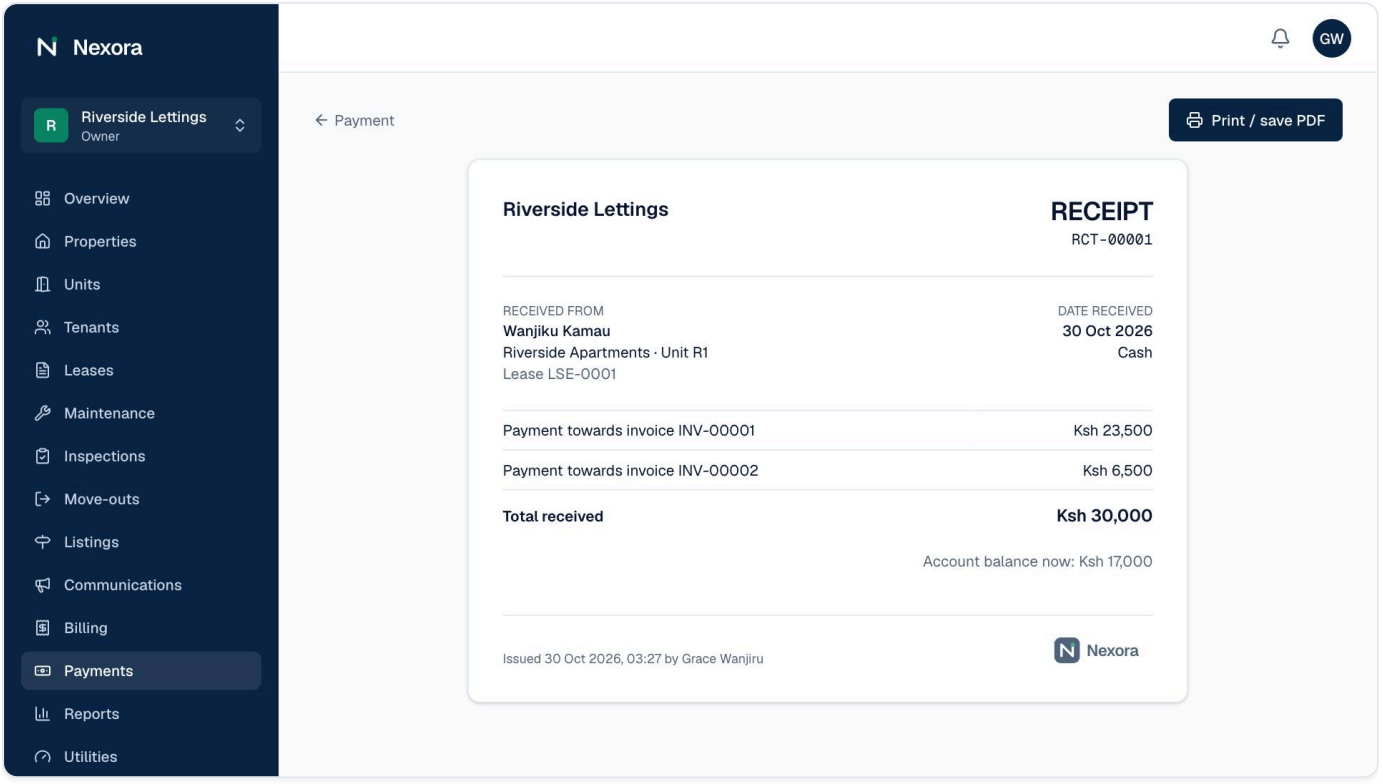
24 **LANDLORD**

The balance drops to **Ksh 17,000**. The payment was applied to the oldest bill first.



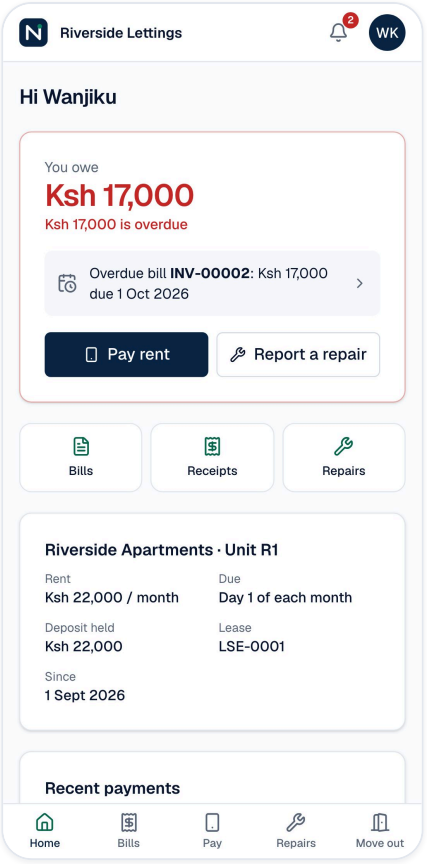
25 **LANDLORD**

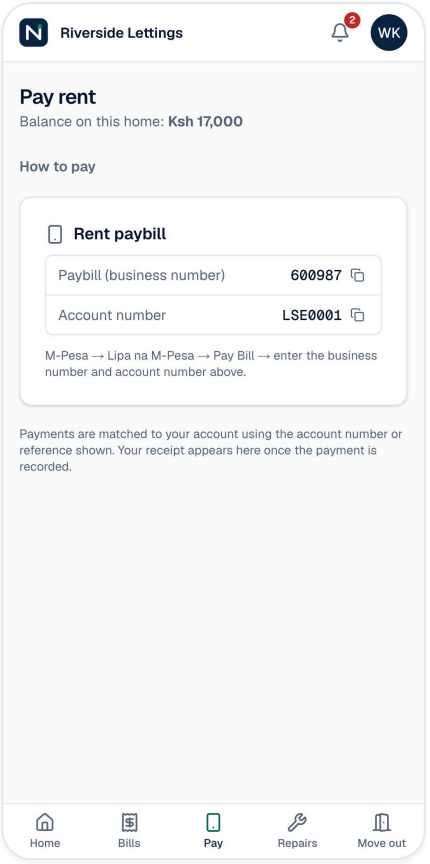
Payments → **RCT-00001** → **Receipt** opens a printable receipt showing the new balance.



26 **TENANT APP**

In the tenant app, **Home** shows Ksh 17,000 owed and the deposit held. **Pay** shows the paybill and her account number, with copy buttons.

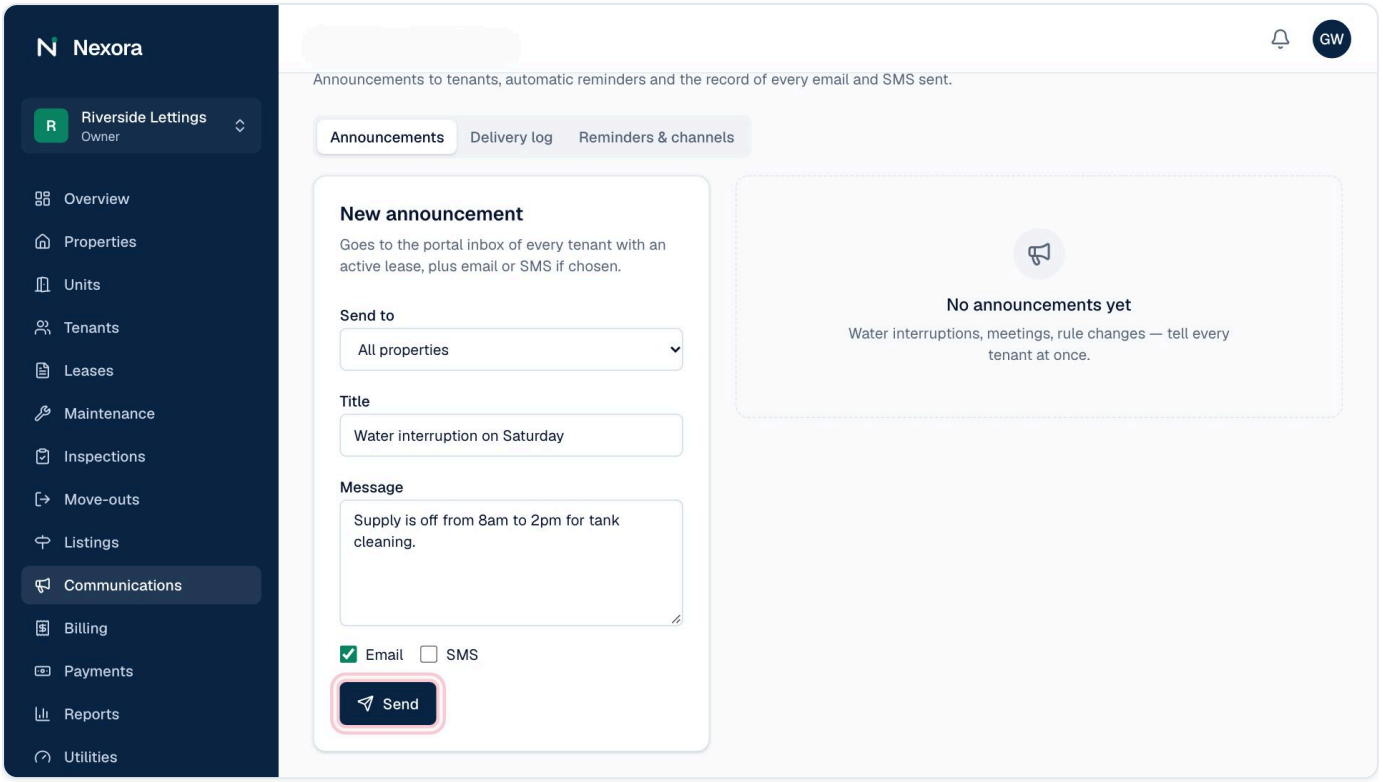




7 Announcement

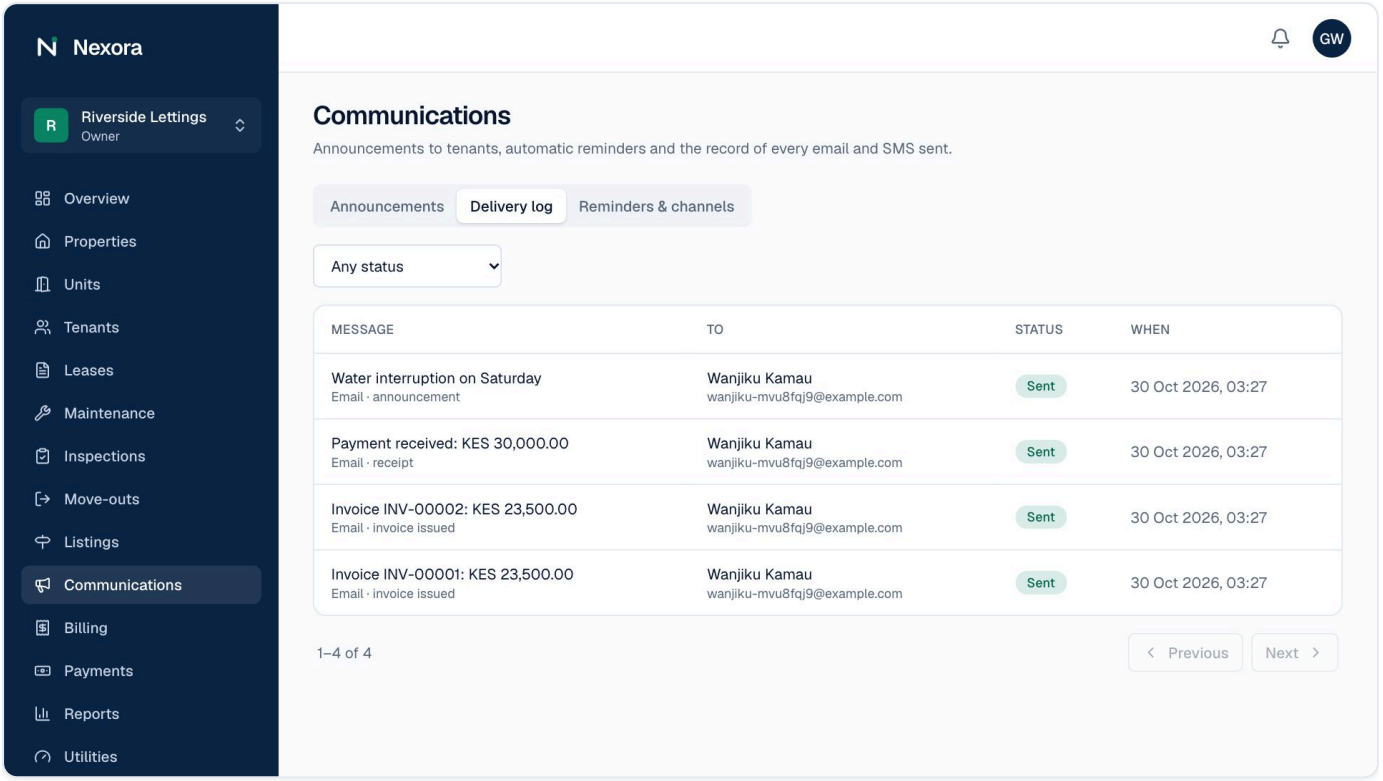
27 LANDLORD

Sidebar **Communications**. Send to *All properties*, Title *Water interruption on Saturday*, a message, **Email** ticked → **Send** → **Send now**. It reaches every tenant with an active lease.



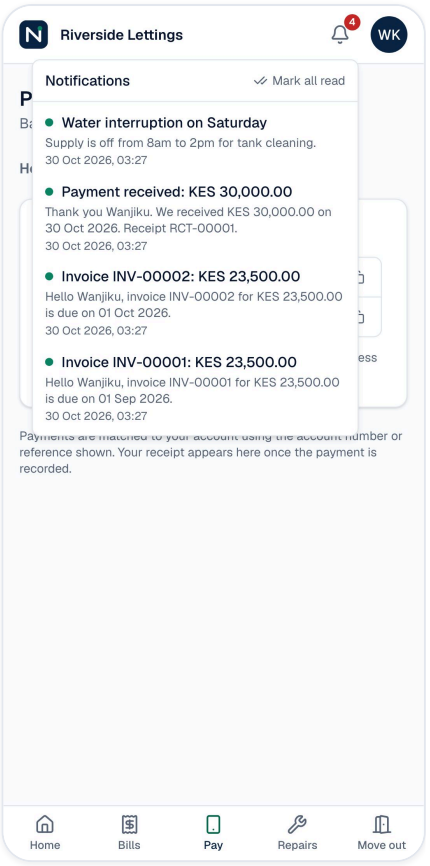
28 LANDLORD

The **Delivery log** tab records every email and SMS sent, with its status.



29 **TENANT APP**

The bell in the tenant app shows the announcement.

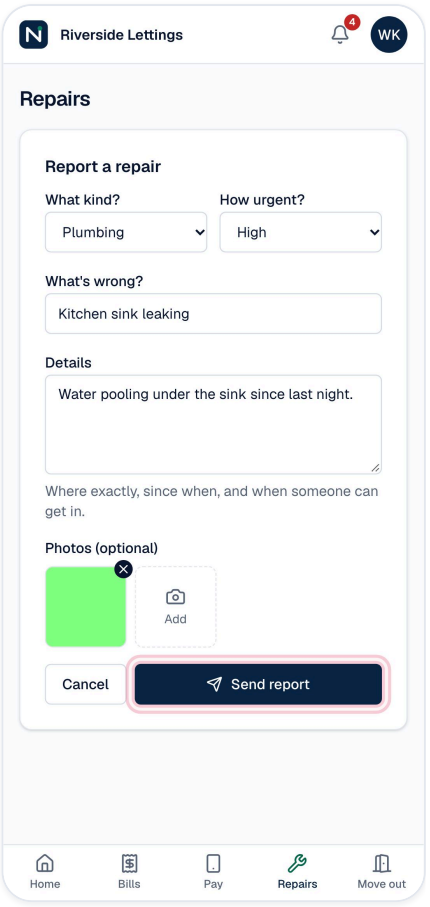


8 A repair reported in the tenant app

Tenants report repairs with photos and follow progress. Staff can add internal notes that tenants never see.

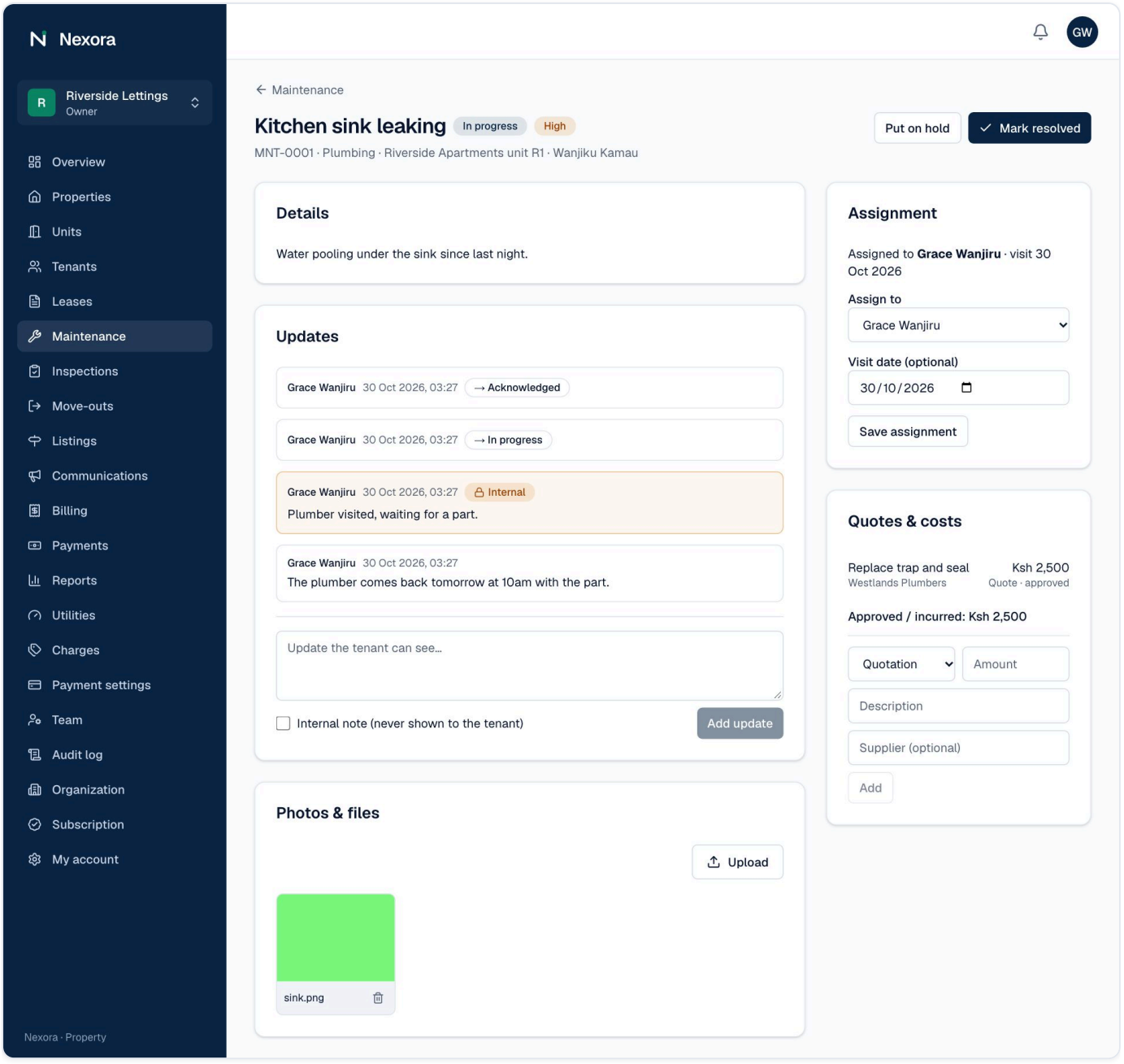
30 TENANT APP

Repairs → **Report a repair**. What kind *Plumbing*, How urgent *High*, What's wrong *Kitchen sink leaking*, details, and a photo (on a phone this opens the camera) → **Send report**.



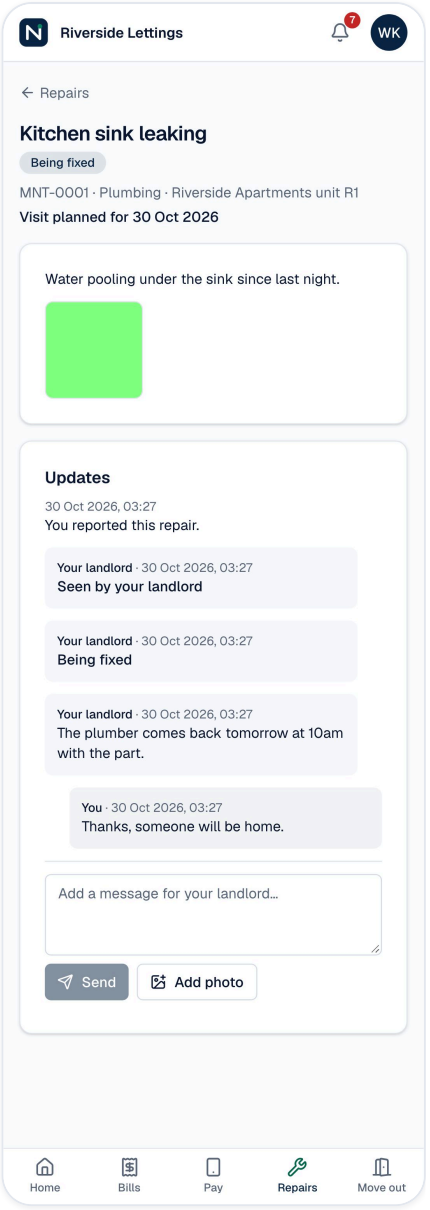
31 **LANDLORD**

Sidebar **Maintenance** → open the request (marked *from tenant*). Click **Acknowledge**; assign it and set a visit date → **Save assignment**; add a **Quotation** of 2,500 and **Approve** it; click **Start work**. Add an **internal note** (tick the box) and a normal update: *The plumber comes back tomorrow at 10am*.



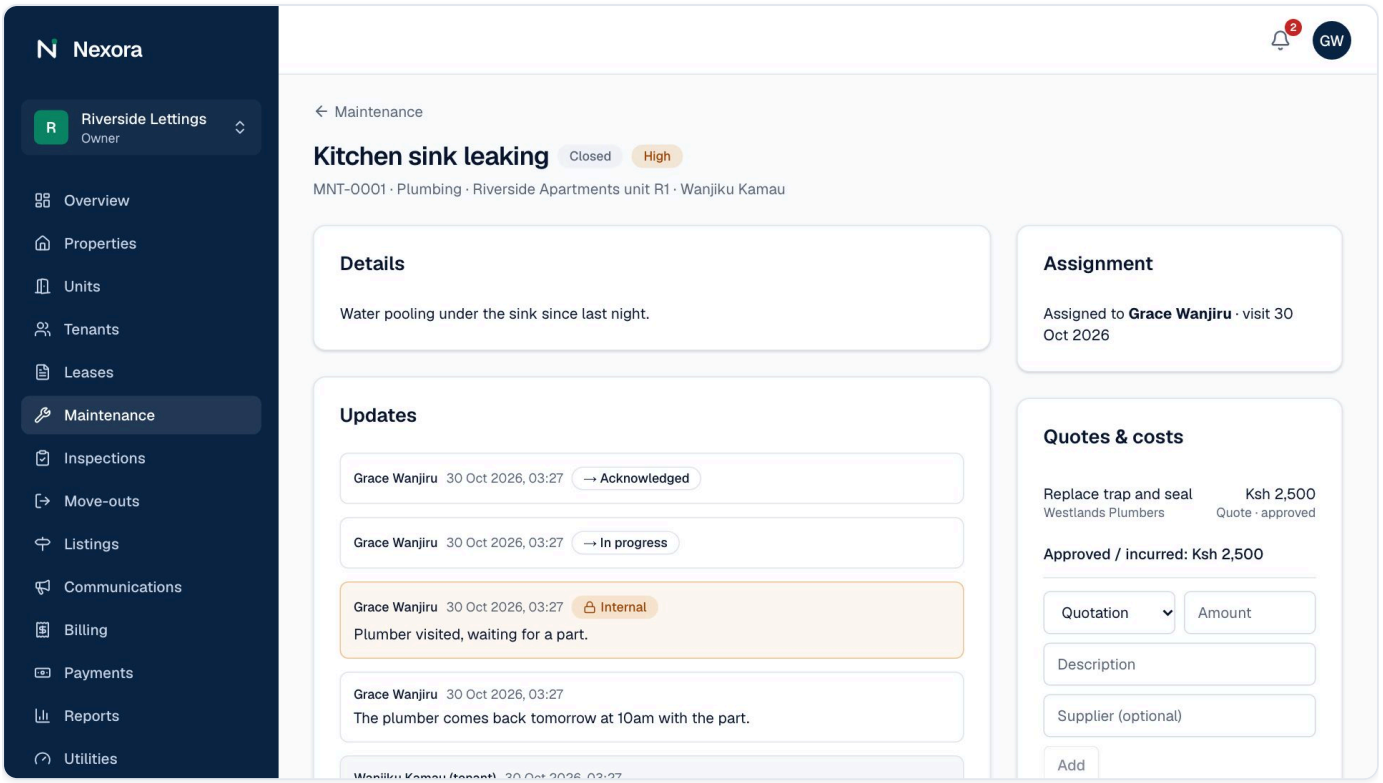
32 TENANT APP

The tenant sees **Being fixed** and the landlord's update, but **not** the internal note. She replies *Thanks, someone will be home*.



33 **LANDLORD**

Refresh to see her reply, then **Mark resolved** and **Close**. The tenant sees **Closed**.

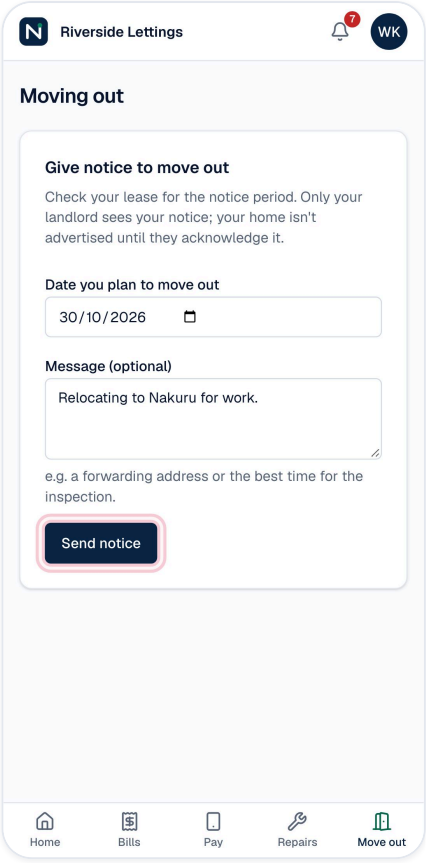


9 Moving out: the notice

A notice stays private until the landlord acknowledges it, so the unit isn't shown as becoming free too early.

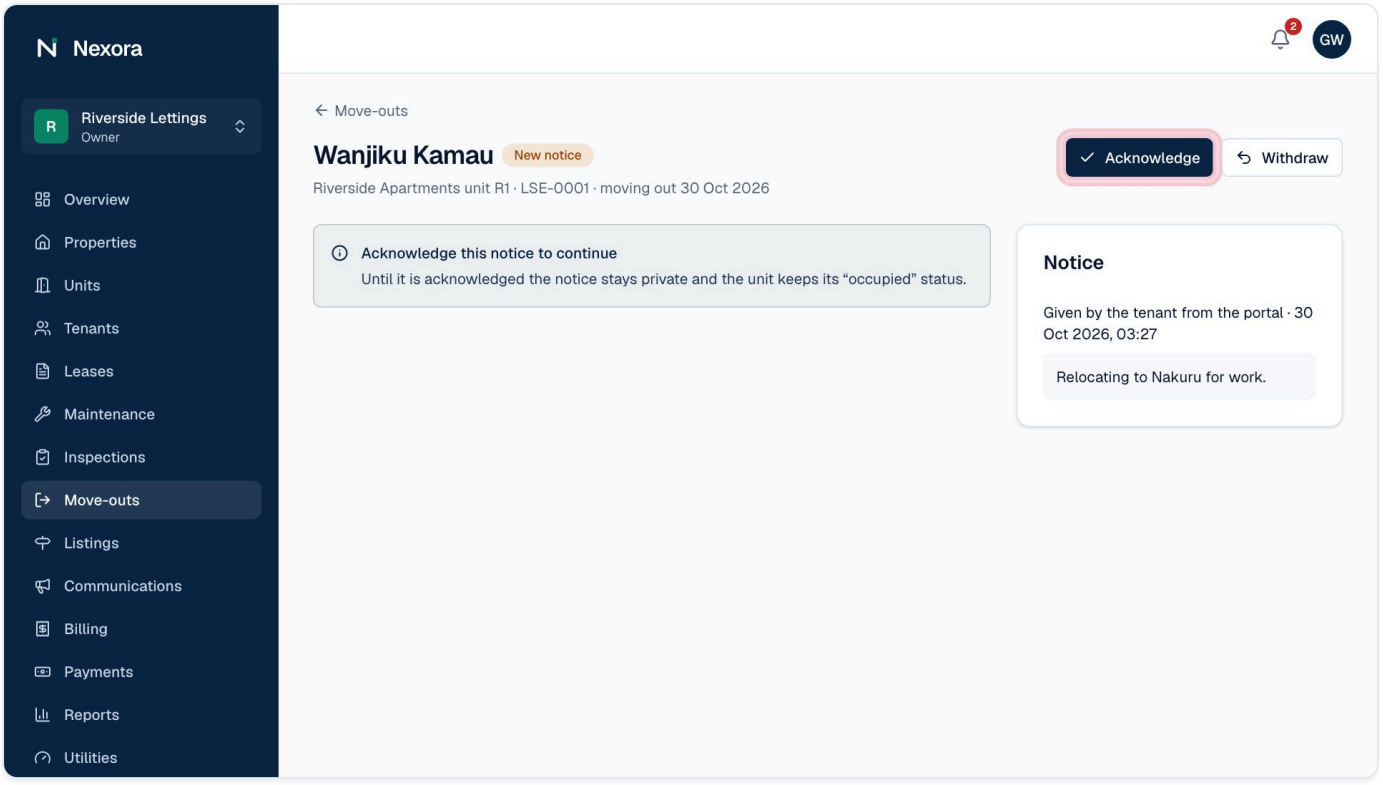
34 TENANT APP

Move out. Date *30 Oct 2026*, a message → **Send notice** → confirm. She can withdraw it until it's acknowledged.



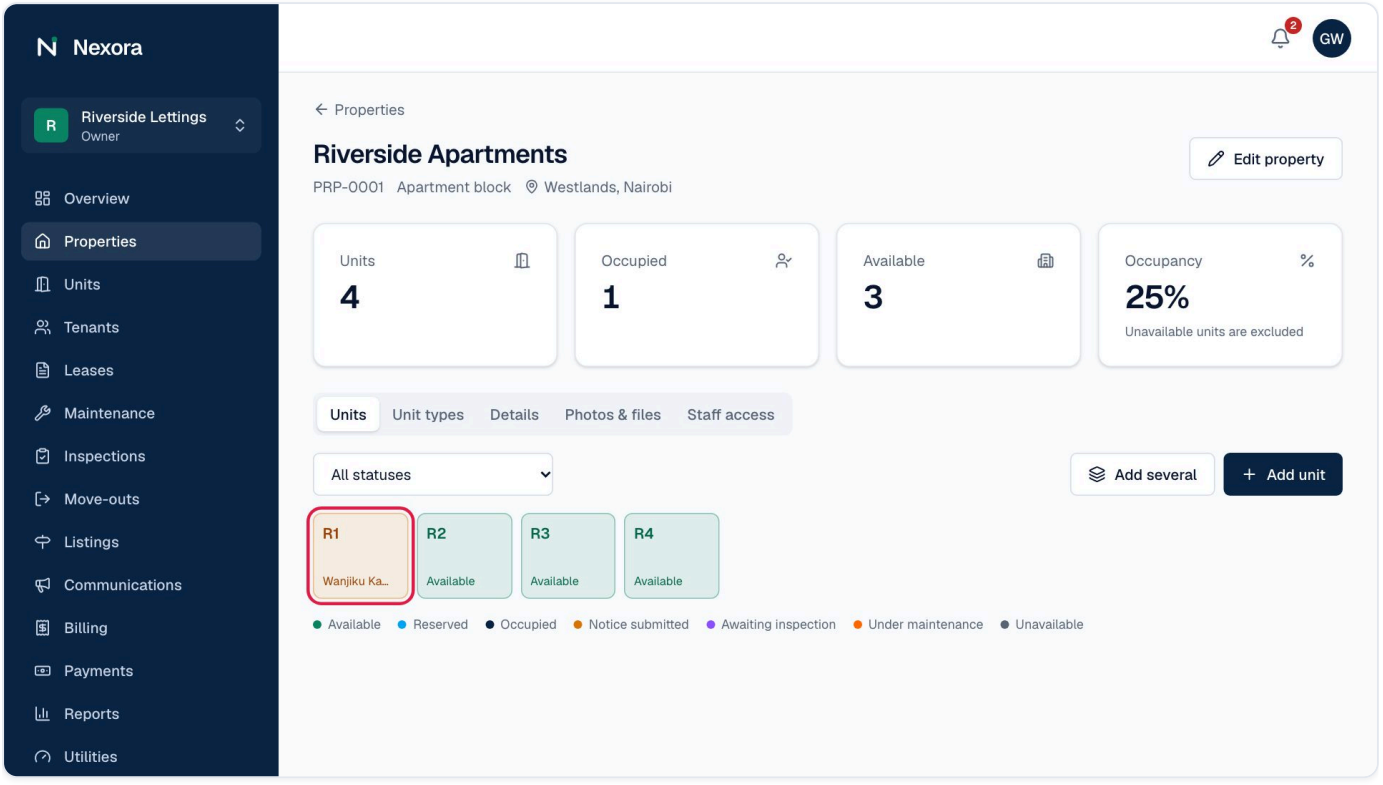
35 **LANDLORD**

Sidebar **Move-outs** → Wanjiku: *Given by the tenant from the portal*, status **New notice**. Click **Acknowledge** (staff notes optional) → **Acknowledge**.



36 **LANDLORD**

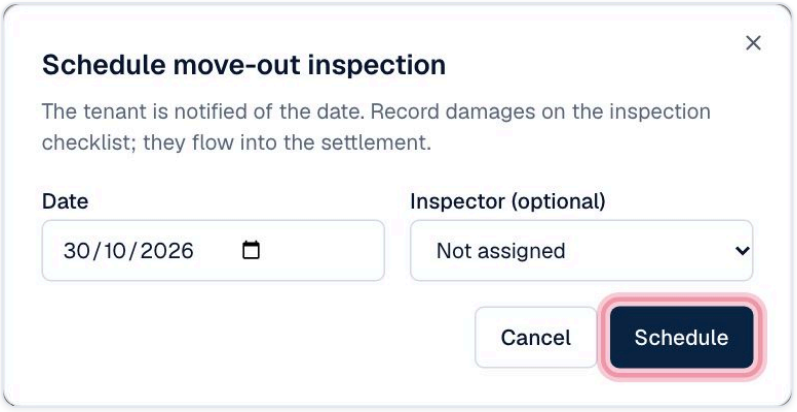
R1 now shows **Notice submitted** on the property page, and the tenant sees **Acknowledged**.



10 Moving out: the inspection

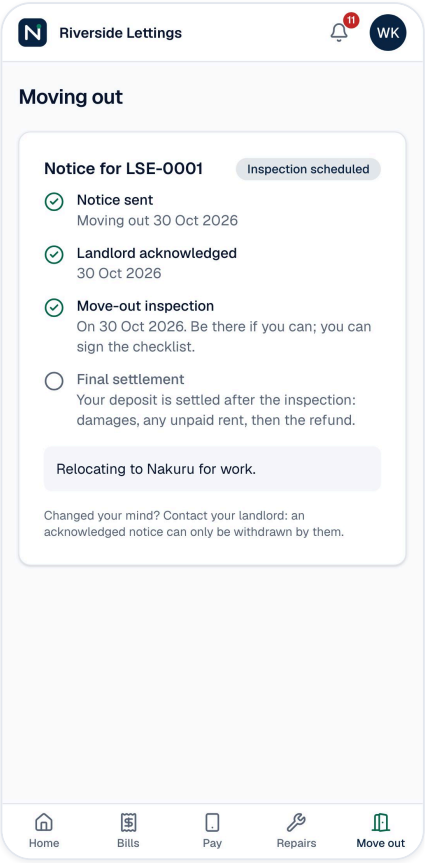
37 LANDLORD

On the move-out page click **Schedule inspection**. Date *30 Oct 2026* → **Schedule**. The tenant is told the date.



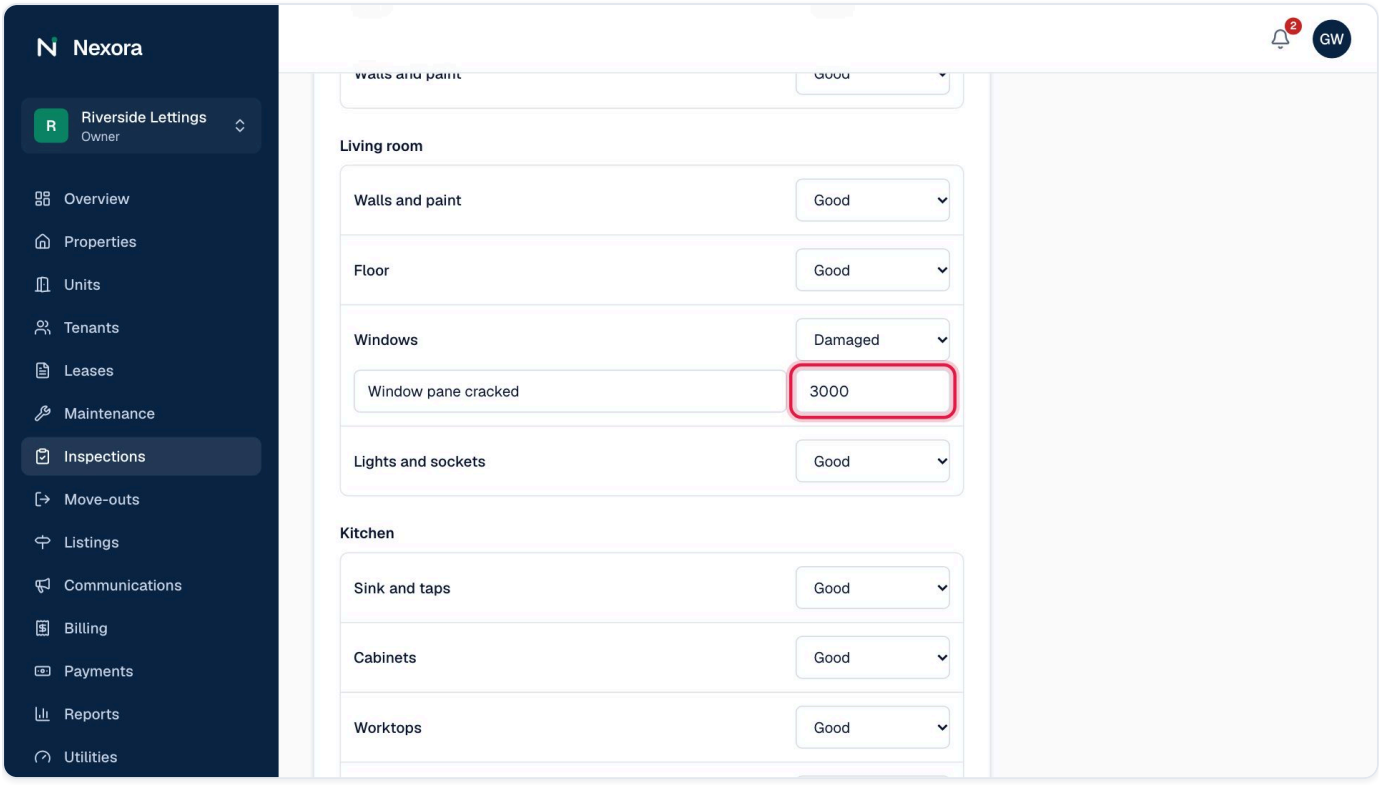
38 TENANT APP

Her **Move out** screen shows each step: notice sent, acknowledged, the inspection date, then the final settlement.



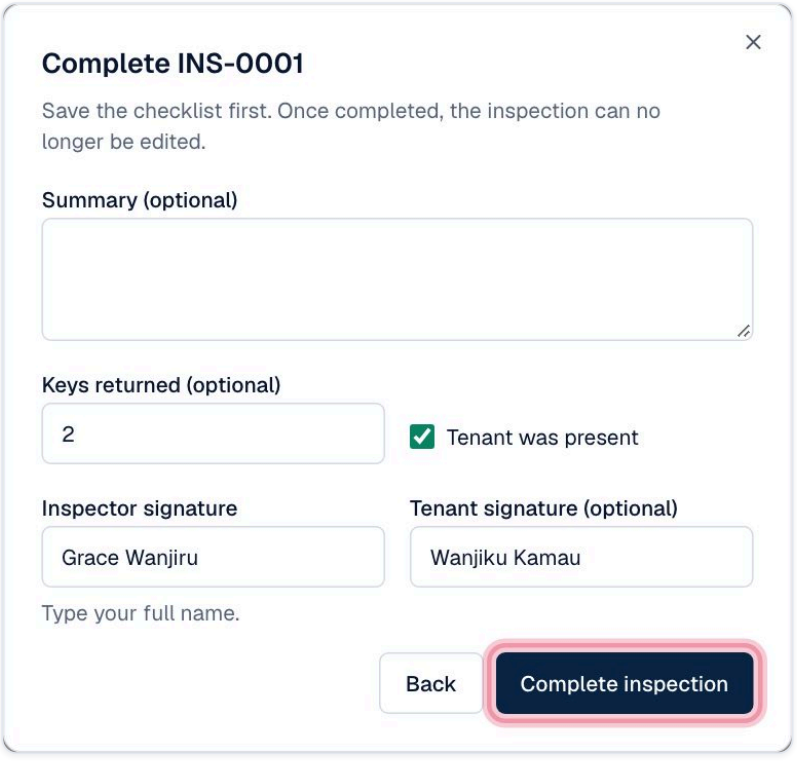
39 LANDLORD

Click the inspection reference (**INS-0001**). Set every item to **Good**, except Living room **Windows** → **Damaged**: notes and a charge box appear. Notes *Window pane cracked*, Charge *3000* → **Save checklist**.



40 LANDLORD

Click **Complete**. Keys returned *2*, tick **Tenant was present**, both signatures (type the names) → **Complete inspection**. The checklist is then locked.



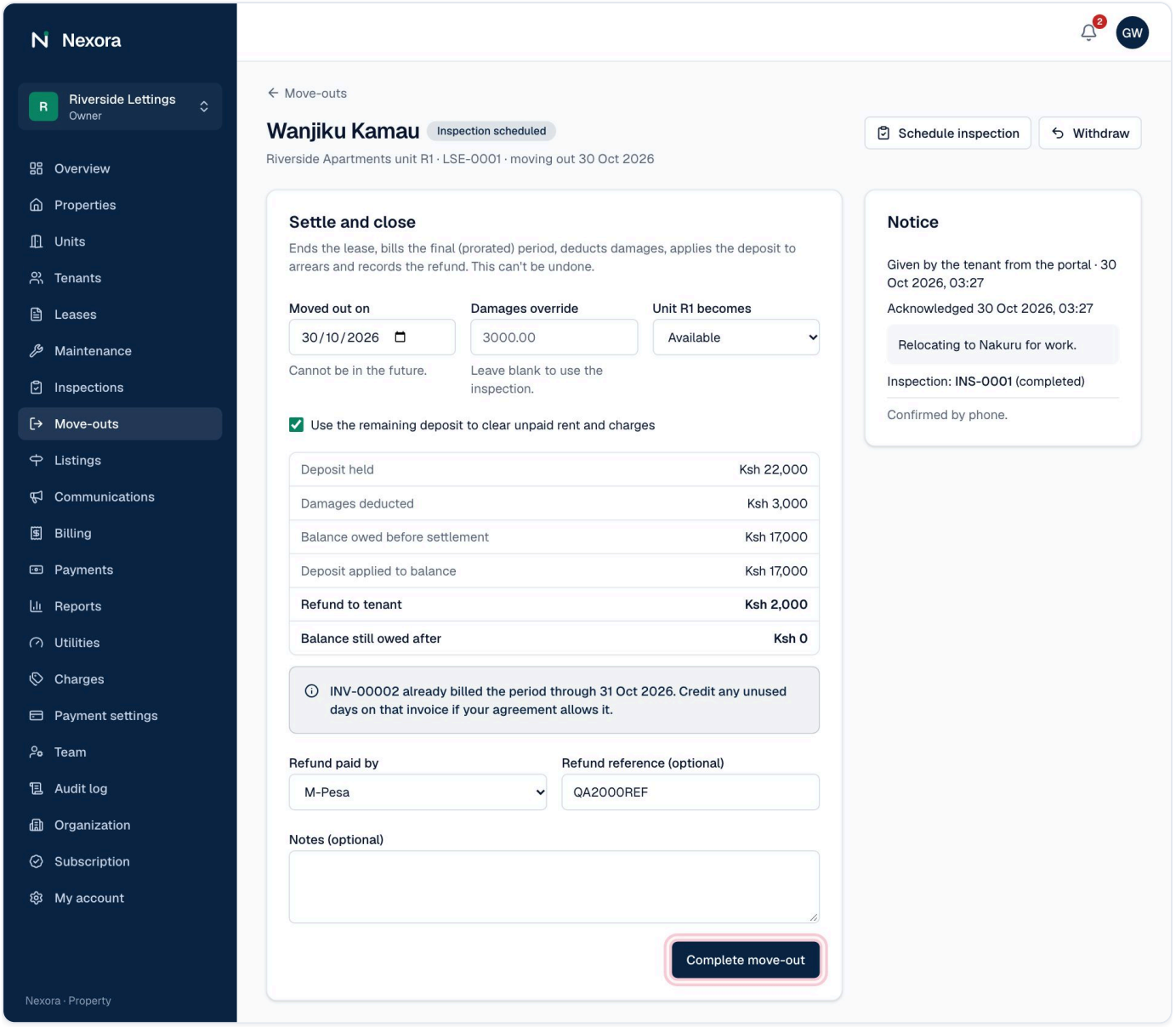
11 Moving out: settlement

One step ends the lease, bills any final days, deducts damages, uses the deposit for unpaid rent and records the refund.

41 LANDLORD

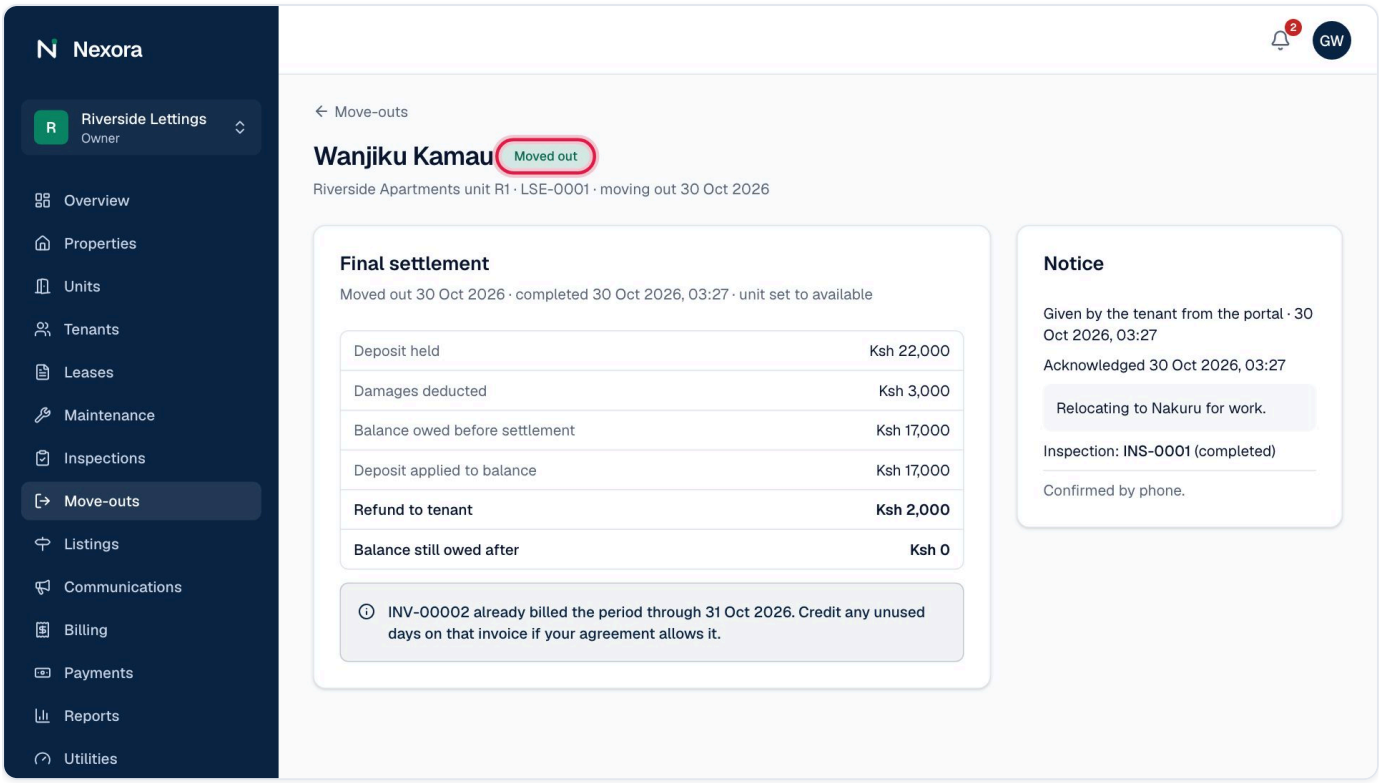
Back on **Move-outs** → **Wanjiku**, the **Settle and close** card shows: deposit 22,000, damages 3,000, owed 17,000, deposit applied 17,000, **refund 2,000**, balance after 0. Set **Unit R1 becomes** *Available*, **Refund paid by** *M-Pesa* with a reference → **Complete move-out** → confirm.

> Damages come from the inspection. Type a different amount in **Damages override**, or untick *Use the remaining deposit to clear unpaid rent and charges* to refund the whole remainder.



42 **LANDLORD**

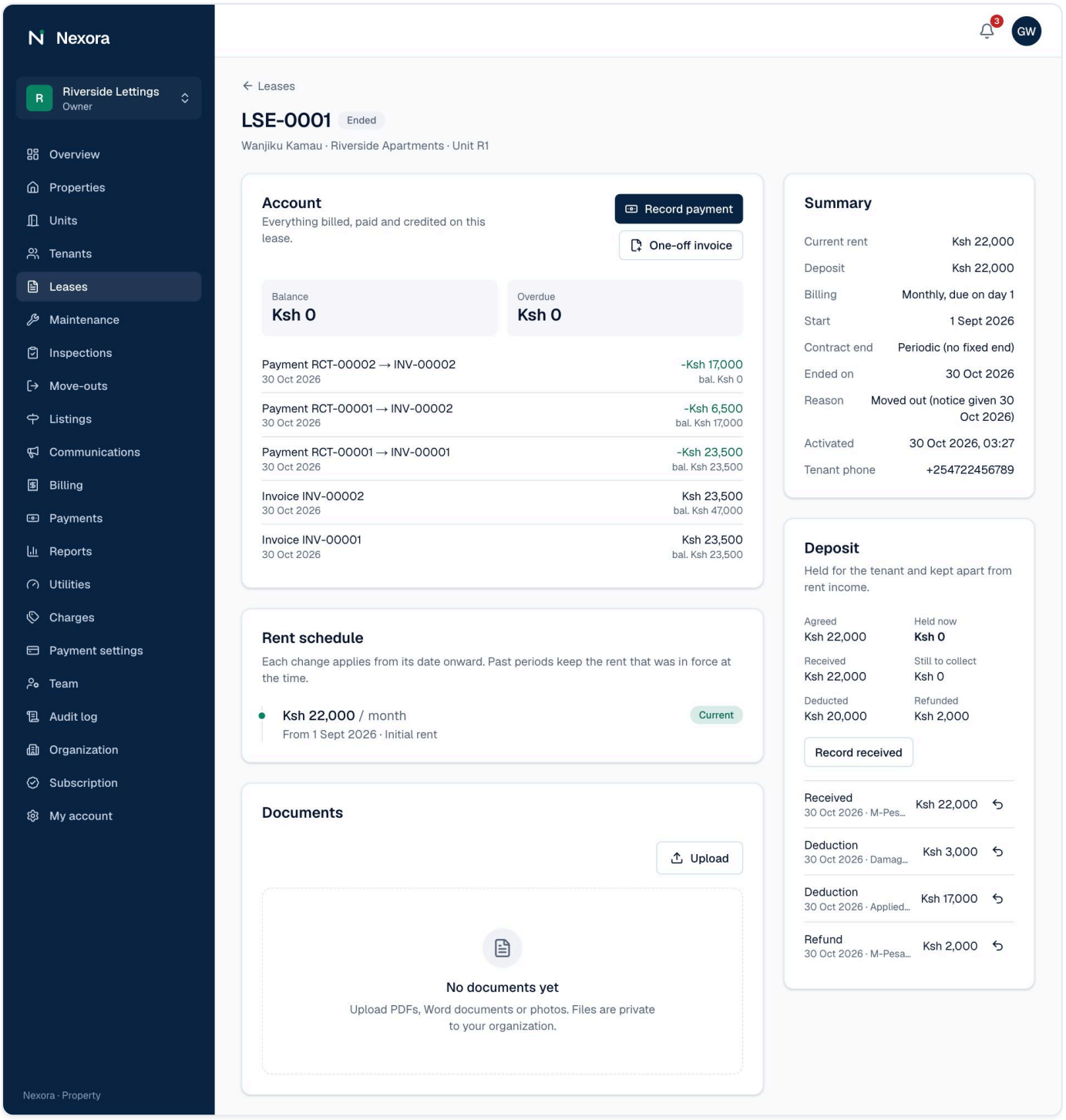
The notice shows **Moved out** with a **Final settlement** record.



12 The end state

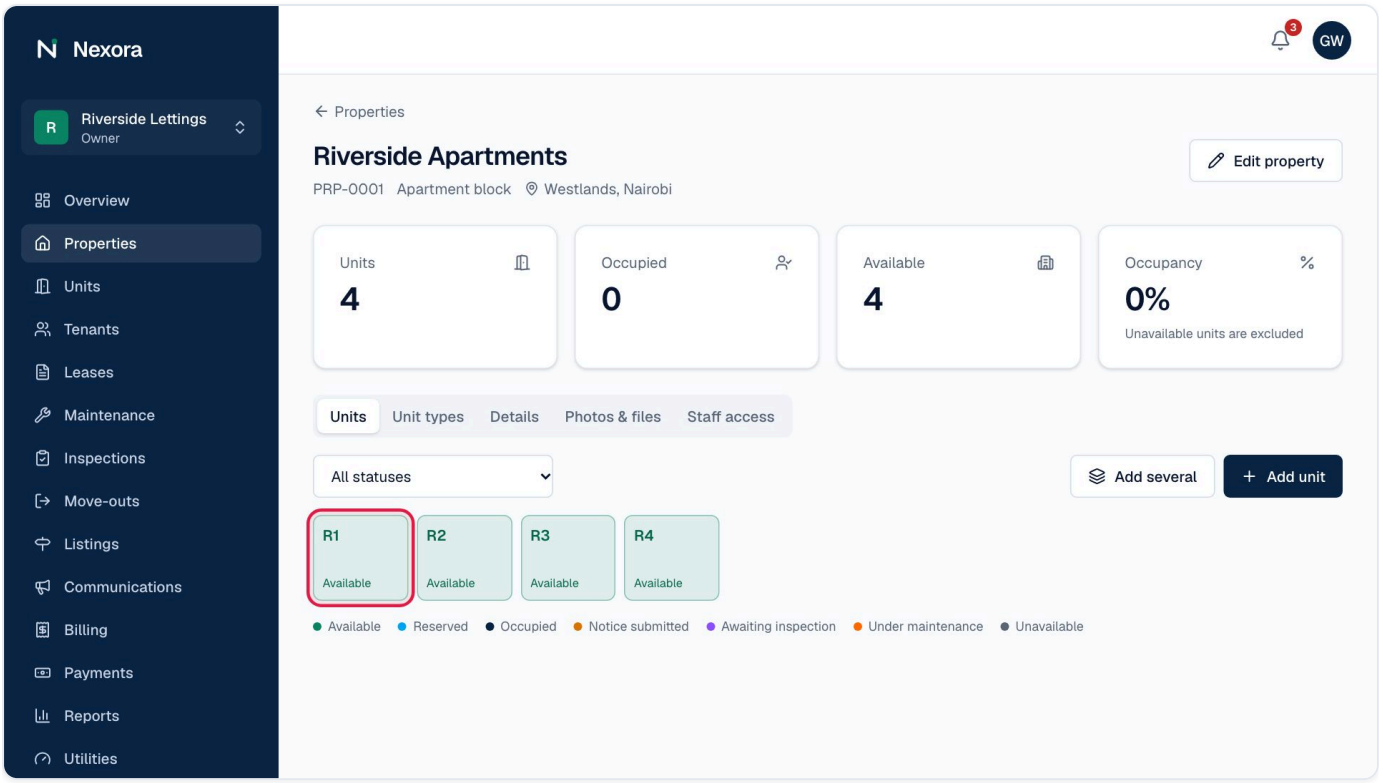
43 **LANDLORD**

The lease shows **Ended** with balance 0. The deposit card shows the 3,000 deduction and the 2,000 refund.



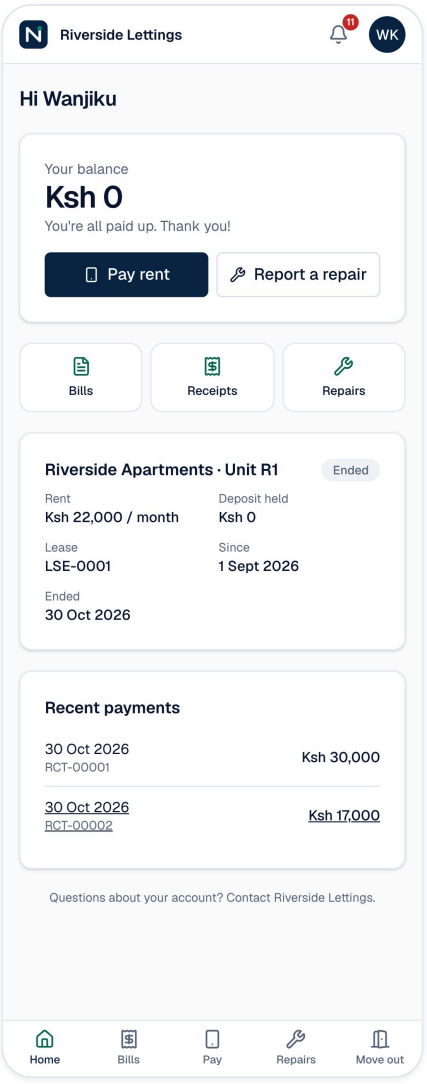
44 **LANDLORD**

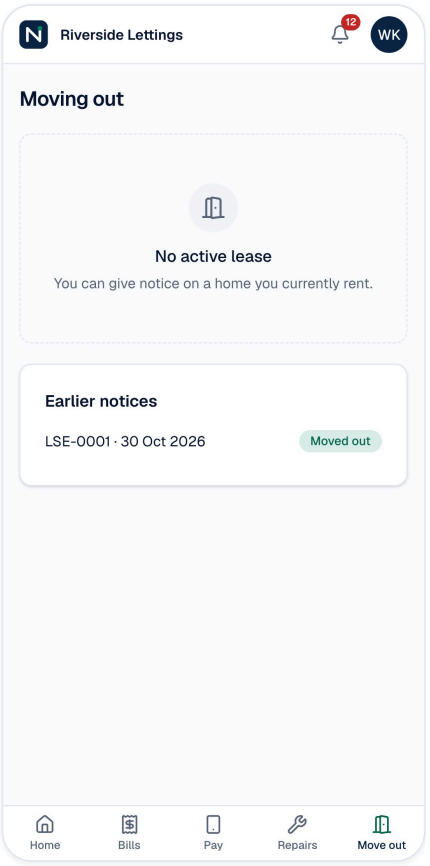
On the property page, R1 is **Available** and ready to let again.



45 **TENANT APP**

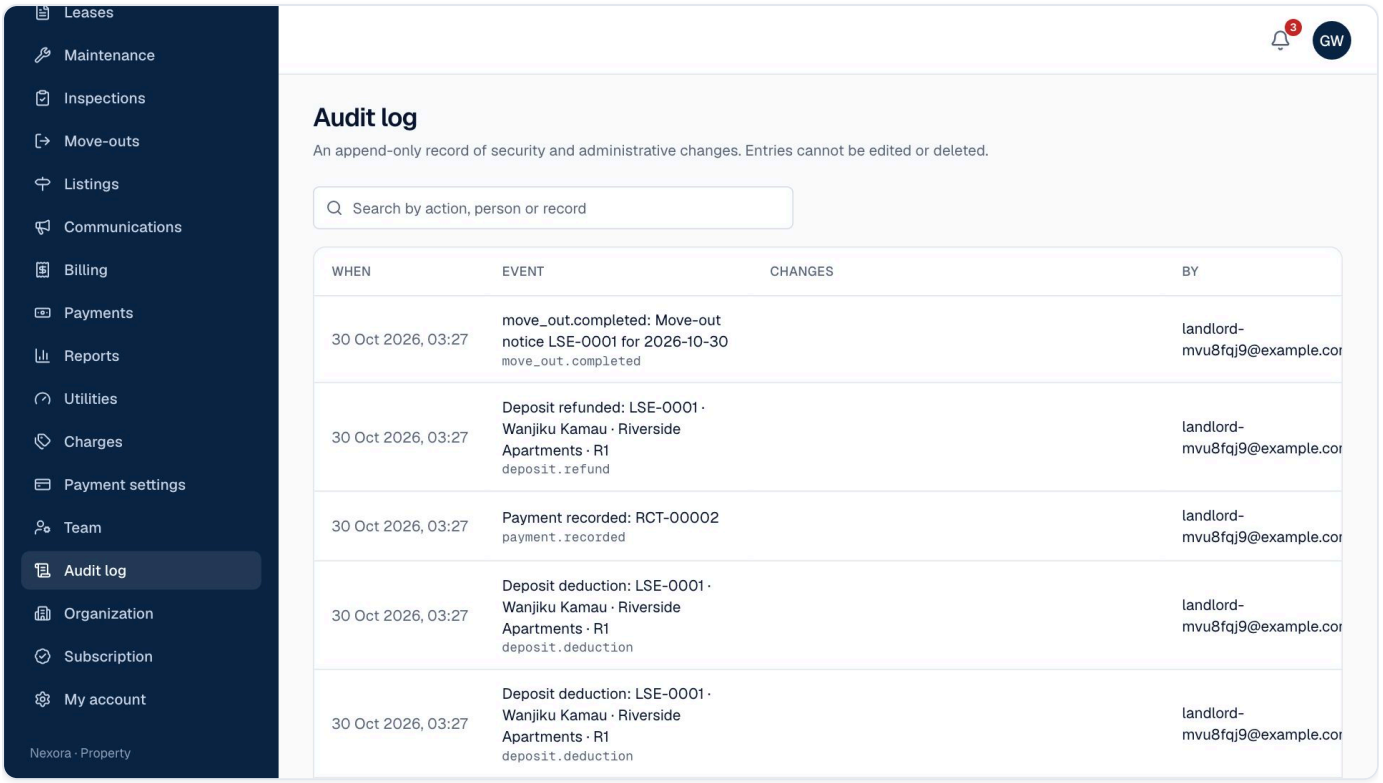
The tenant app says *You're all paid up*, the home is marked **Ended**, and **Move out** shows **Moved out**. Her bills and receipts stay available.





46 **LANDLORD**

Sidebar **Audit log** lists every action above, by staff and by the tenant, with who did it and when.



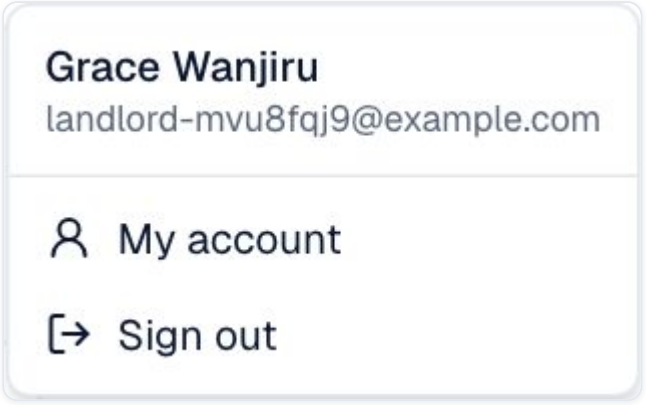
13 Every tab in the landlord dashboard

A reference to the landlord's window. The sidebar on the left lists every area; it shows only what your role is allowed to use, so a caretaker or accountant sees fewer tabs than the owner. The sidebar stays in place while a page scrolls (on a short screen the list of tabs scrolls on its own). On a phone or small screen it folds into the ≡ menu at the top left.

Header

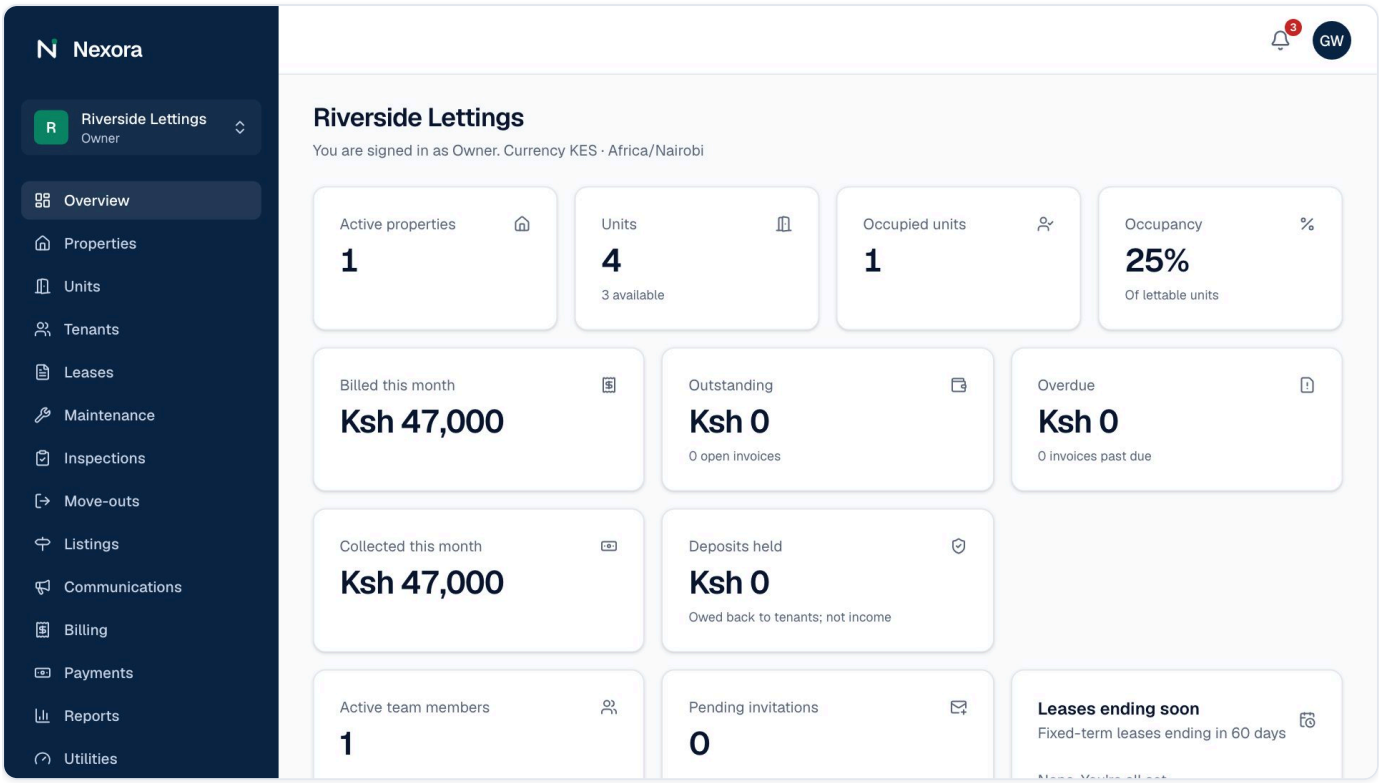
Top right of every page. The **bell** lists your notifications (new repairs, move-out notices, leases ending) with a red count of unread ones; click one to open it, or **Mark all read**. The **round initials** open your account menu: **My account**, **My tenant portal** if you also rent somewhere, and **Sign out**. If you belong to more than one organization, switch between them with the name at the top of the sidebar.





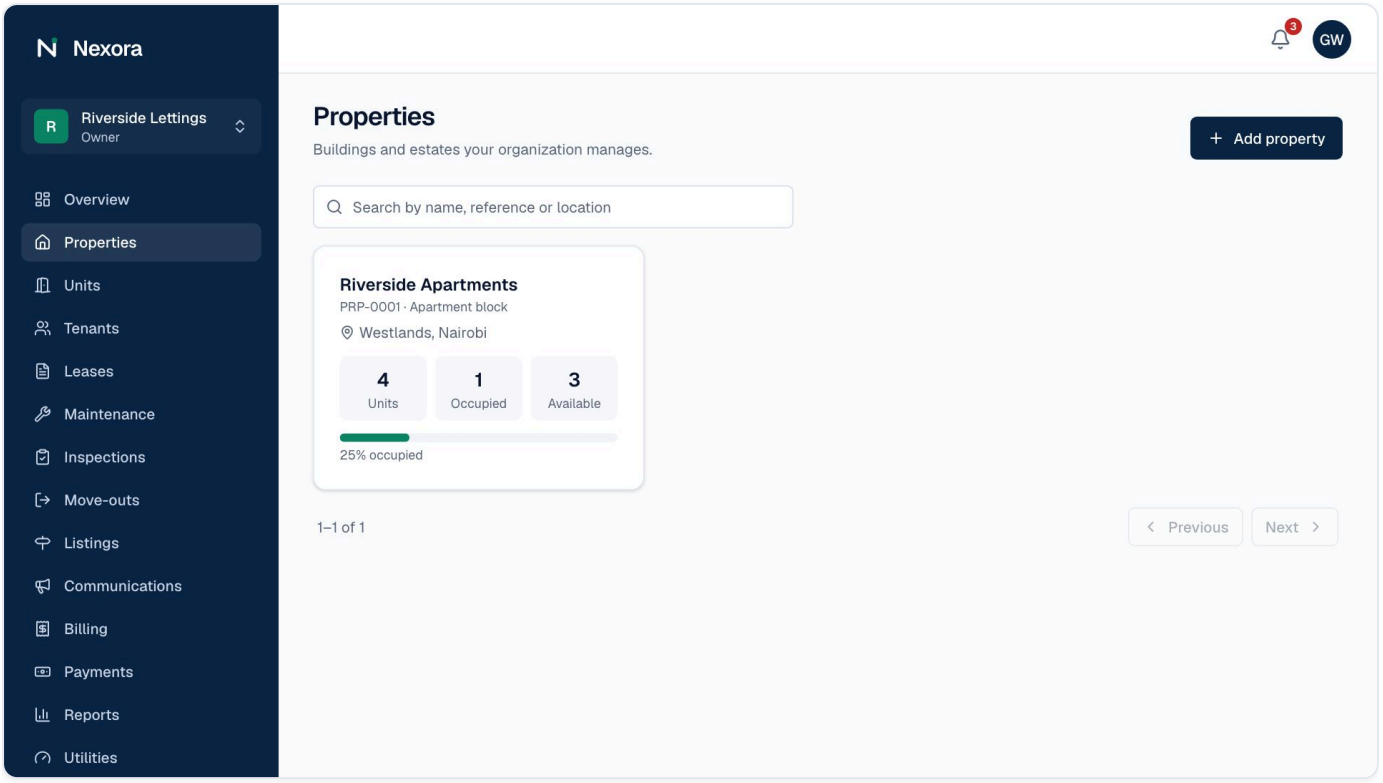
Sidebar → Overview

Your organization at a glance: properties, units and occupancy; what was billed and collected this month; what's outstanding and overdue; deposits held (kept apart from income); team members and pending invitations; leases ending in the next 60 days; and recent activity. Start here each morning.



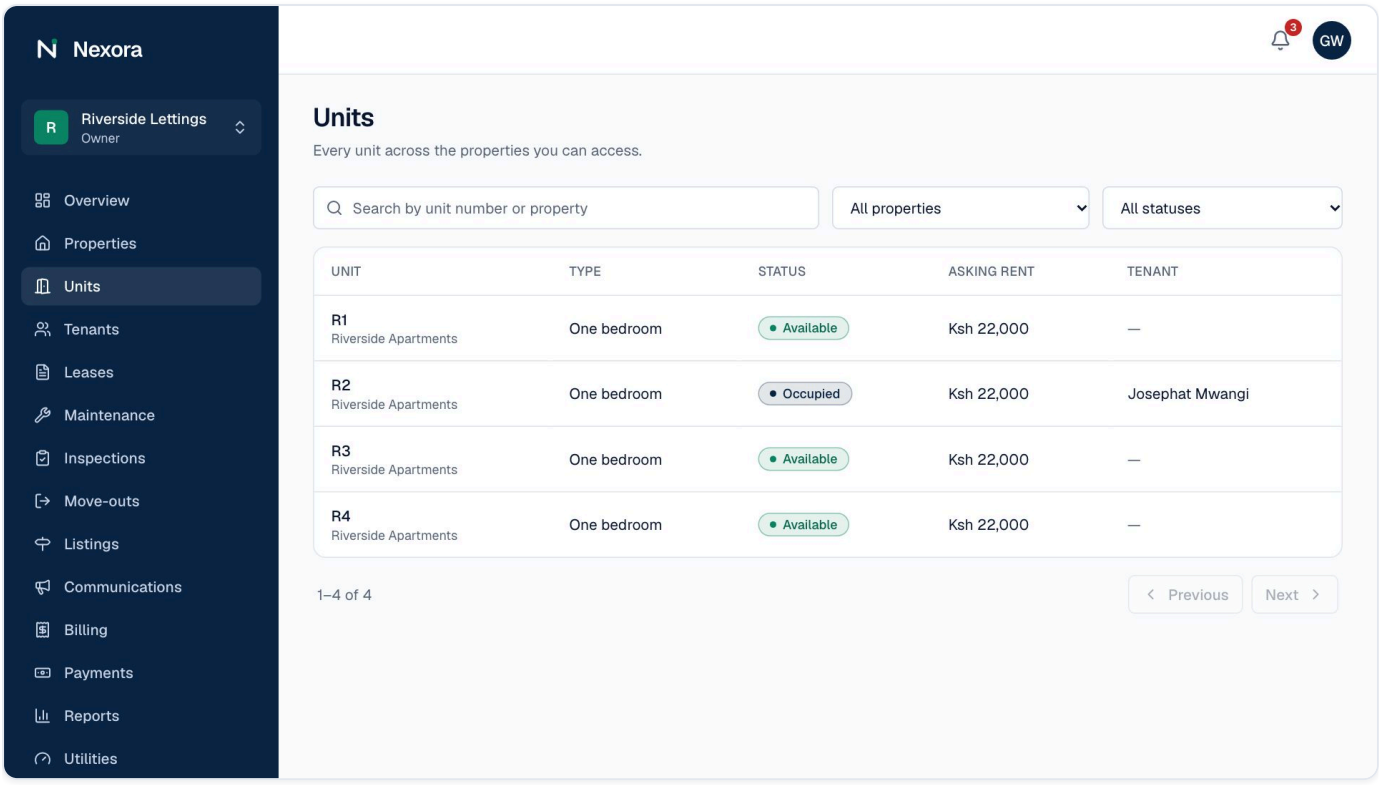
Sidebar → Properties

Your buildings, with their units and occupancy. **Add property** to create one. Open a property for its tabs: **Units** (a colour-coded grid; click a unit to change its status, or add one or several), **Unit types** (the kinds of home with default rent and deposit), **Details** (address, amenities, map), **Photos & files**, and **Staff access** (which managers and caretakers can work on it).



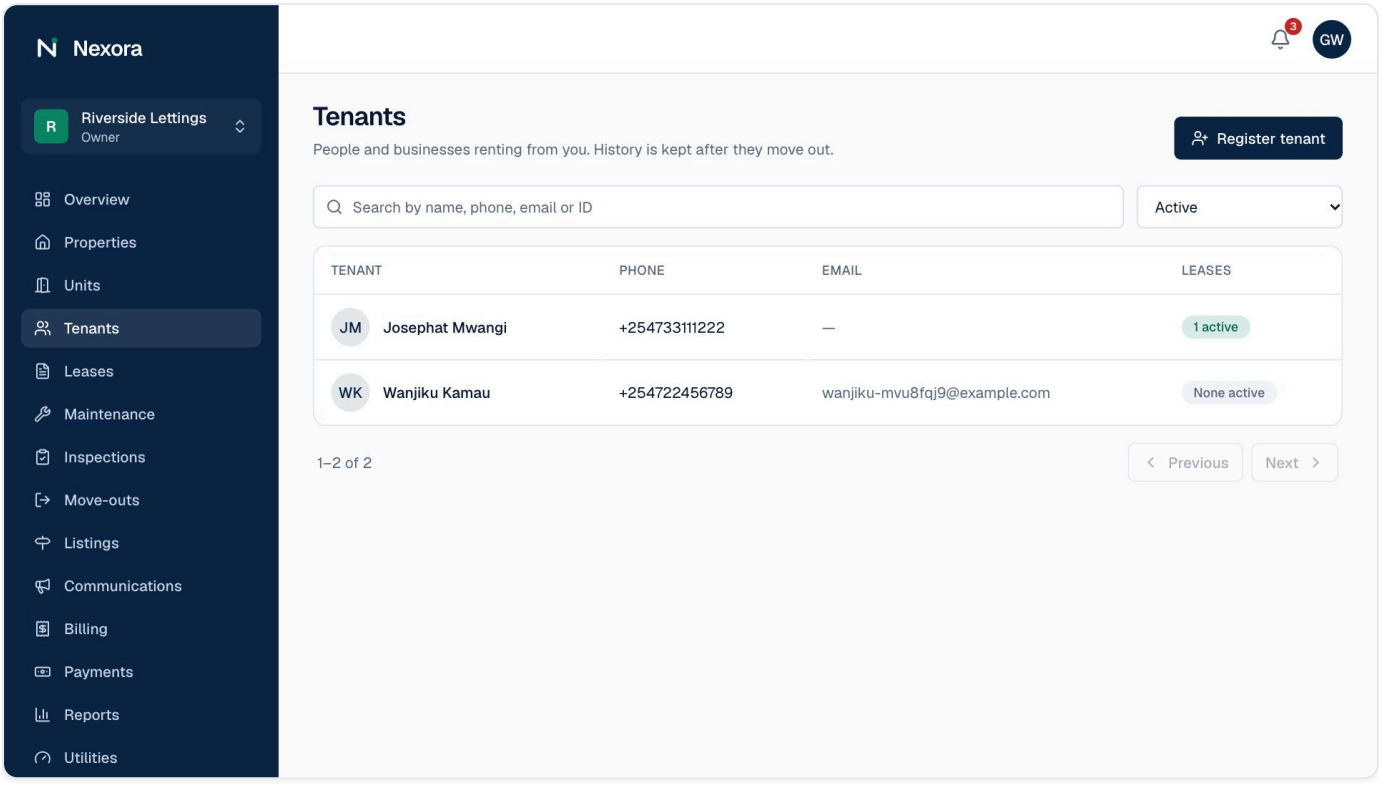
Sidebar → Units

Every unit across your properties in one list, with its status, type and tenant. Filter by property or status to find vacant units quickly. Click a unit to see its details, edit it or change its status (e.g. under maintenance).



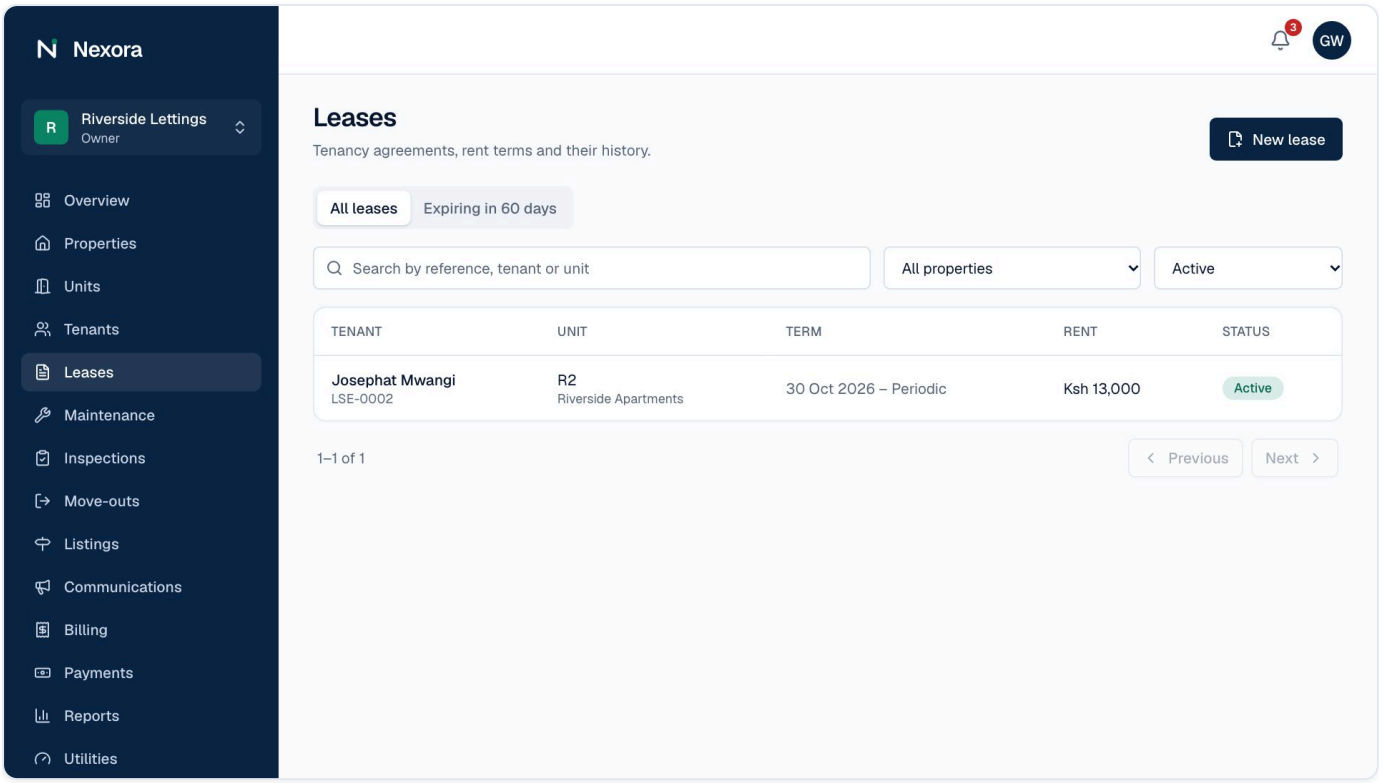
Sidebar → Tenants

Everyone renting from you. **Register tenant** to add someone. A tenant's page shows contacts, ID details (visible only to staff who manage tenants), their leases, balance owed, documents, and the **Tenant app** card to invite them. Archiving hides a tenant but keeps their history.



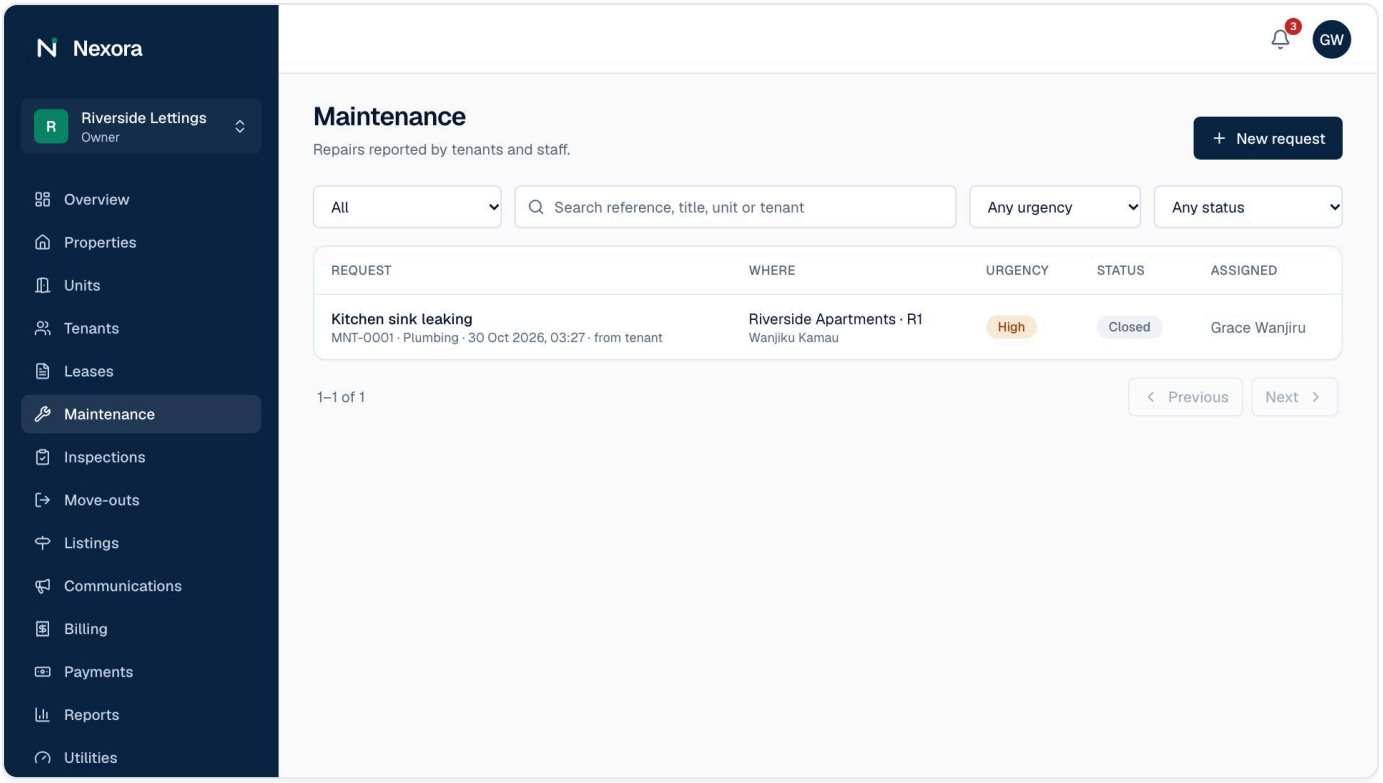
Sidebar → Leases

All tenancies, with an **Expiring** tab for leases ending soon. **New lease** lets a unit. A lease page is the tenant's account: balance and statement, **Record payment**, **One-off invoice** for extra charges, the rent schedule (**Schedule rent change**), the deposit, documents, **Record move-out notice** and **End lease**.



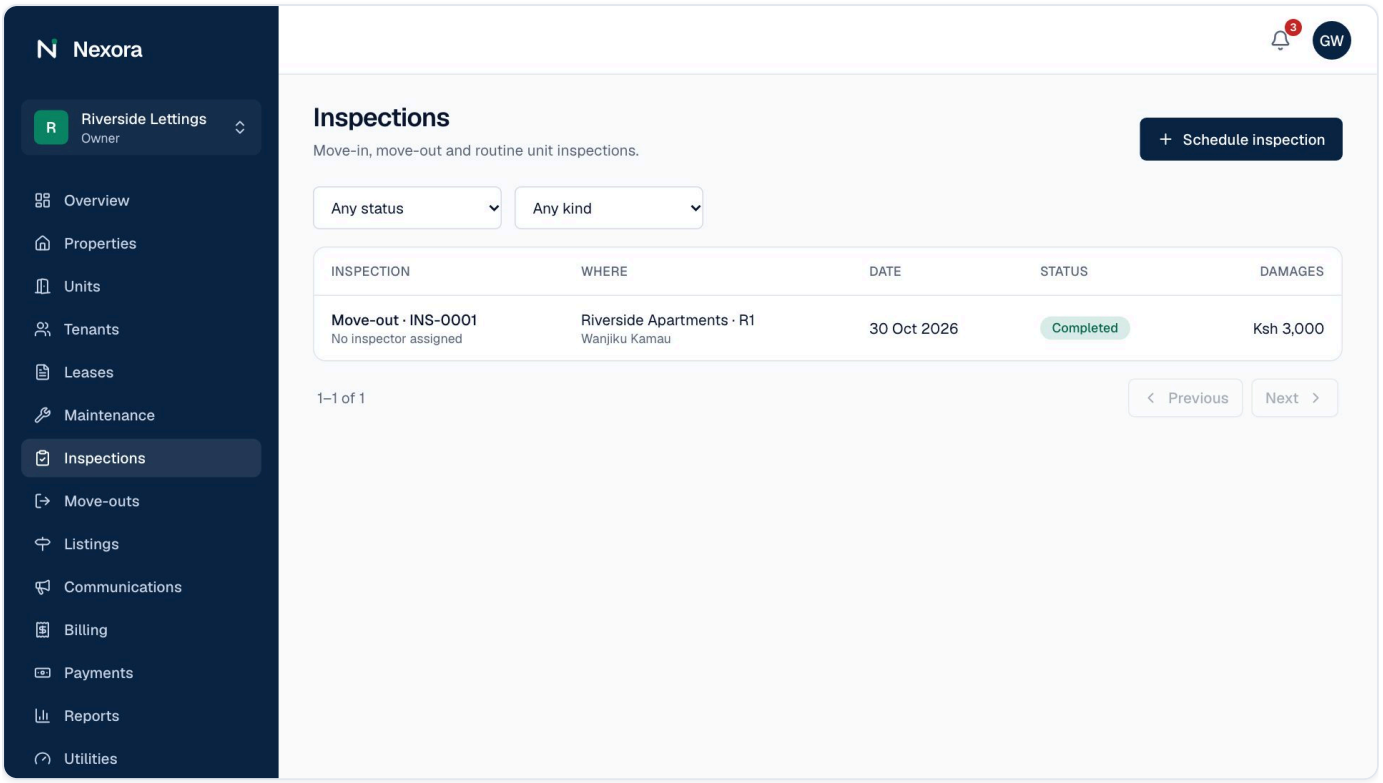
Sidebar → Maintenance

Repairs reported by tenants (in the tenant app) and by staff. Switch the view between **Open**, **Assigned to me** and **All**, and filter by urgency or status. **New request** logs one reported by phone. A request page has the status buttons, updates (visible to the tenant, or internal), assignment and visit date, quotes and costs (only for staff allowed to see costs), and photos.



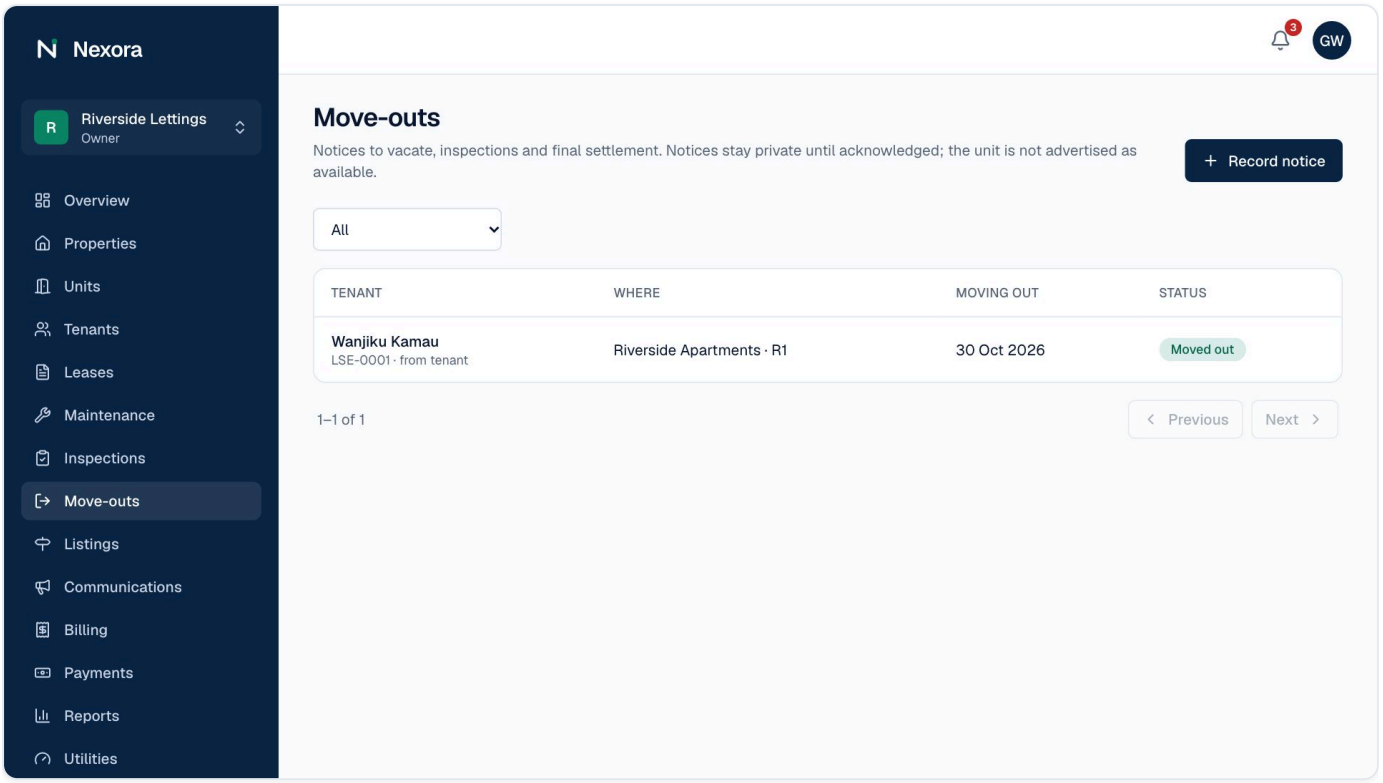
Sidebar → Inspections

Move-in, move-out and routine inspections. **Schedule inspection** picks the unit, kind, date and inspector; a standard checklist is added. Fill in each item's condition, add notes, photos and (for move-out) damage charges, then **Complete** with signatures. Move-out damages flow into the settlement.



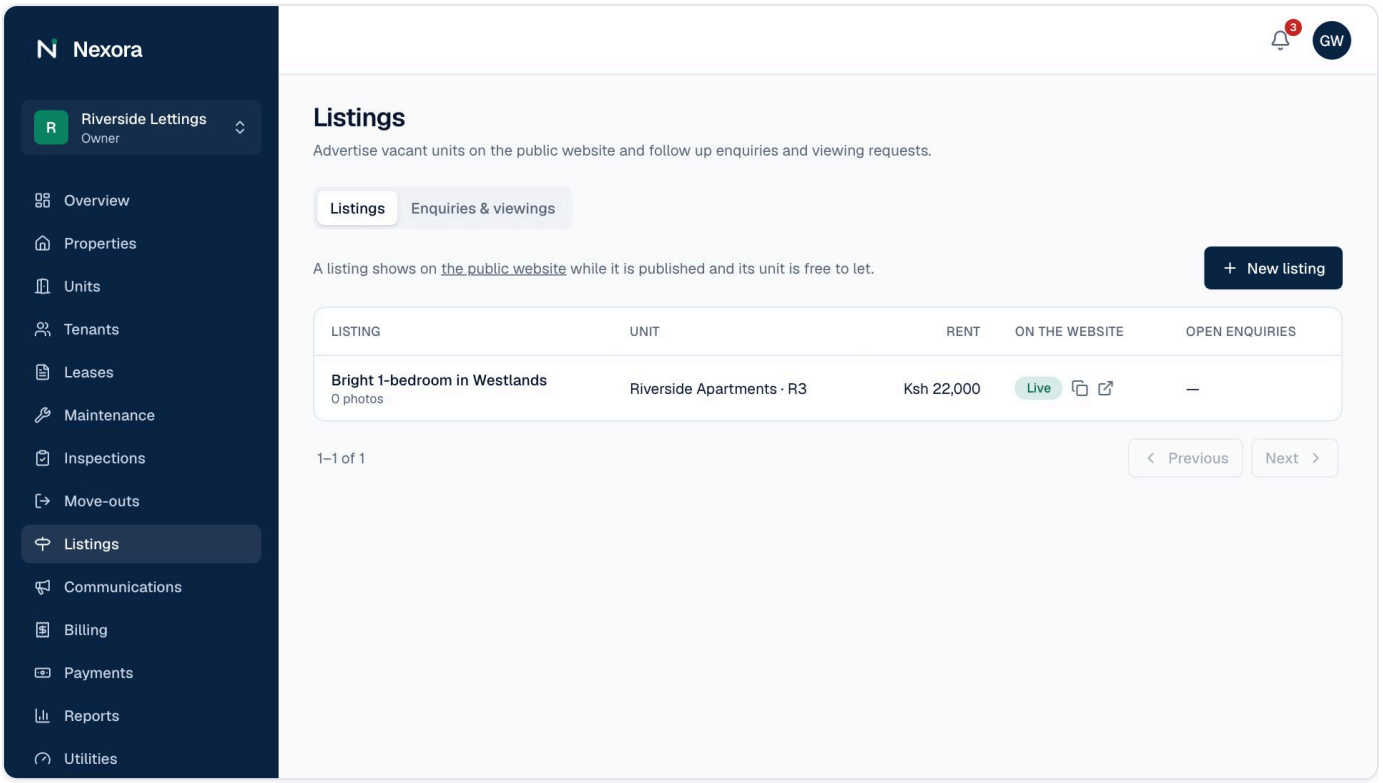
Sidebar → Move-outs

Notices to vacate, from the tenant app or recorded by staff (**Record notice**). A notice stays private until you acknowledge it. Each notice takes you through the inspection and the one-step settlement: final bill, damages, deposit, refund, lease closed and unit released.



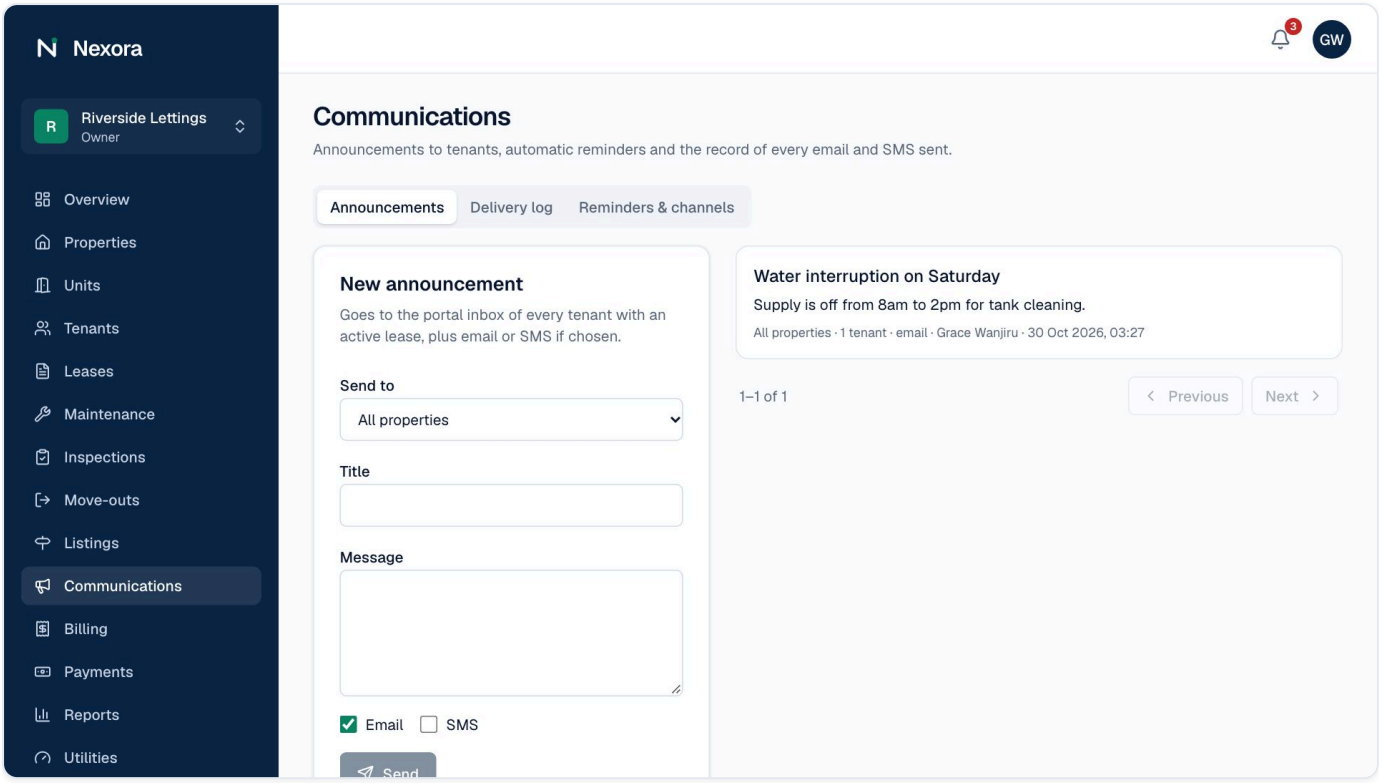
Sidebar → Listings

Advertise vacant units on the public website (the **Find a home** page). **New listing** picks a unit and sets a title, description, available-from date and the photos to show; only the town and county are public, never the street address, and only the photos you tick are published. A listing is shown while it is published and the unit is free to let, and comes down by itself once the unit is let. **Enquiries & viewings** collects questions and viewing requests from the website (you're notified of each one): call them, **book a viewing** (they're emailed the time), keep internal notes, and close each one with its outcome.



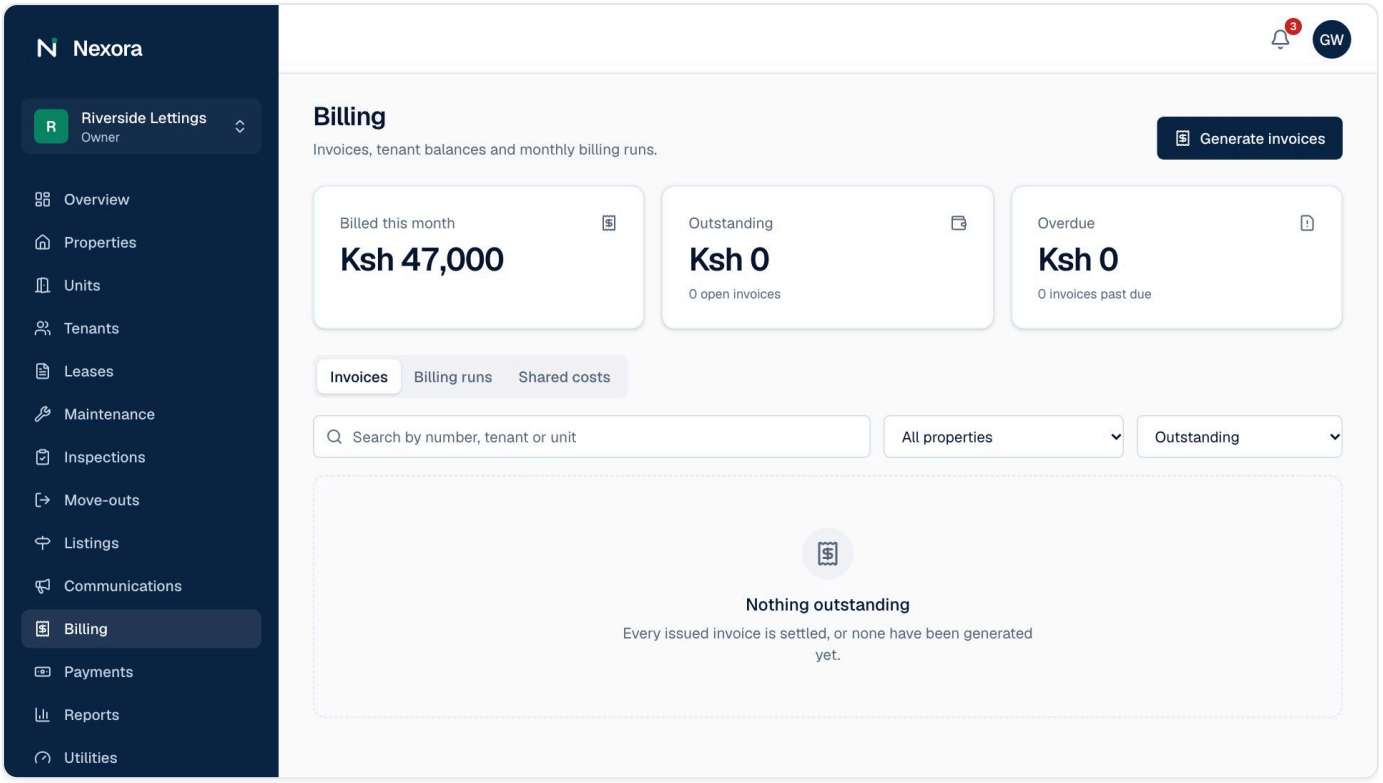
Sidebar → Communications

Announcements to all tenants or one property, by app notification, email and SMS. **Delivery log**: every email and SMS sent, and whether it was delivered. **Reminders & channels**: switch email and SMS on or off, invoice and receipt notices, how many days before the due date rent reminders go out, arrears reminders, and lease-expiry alerts.



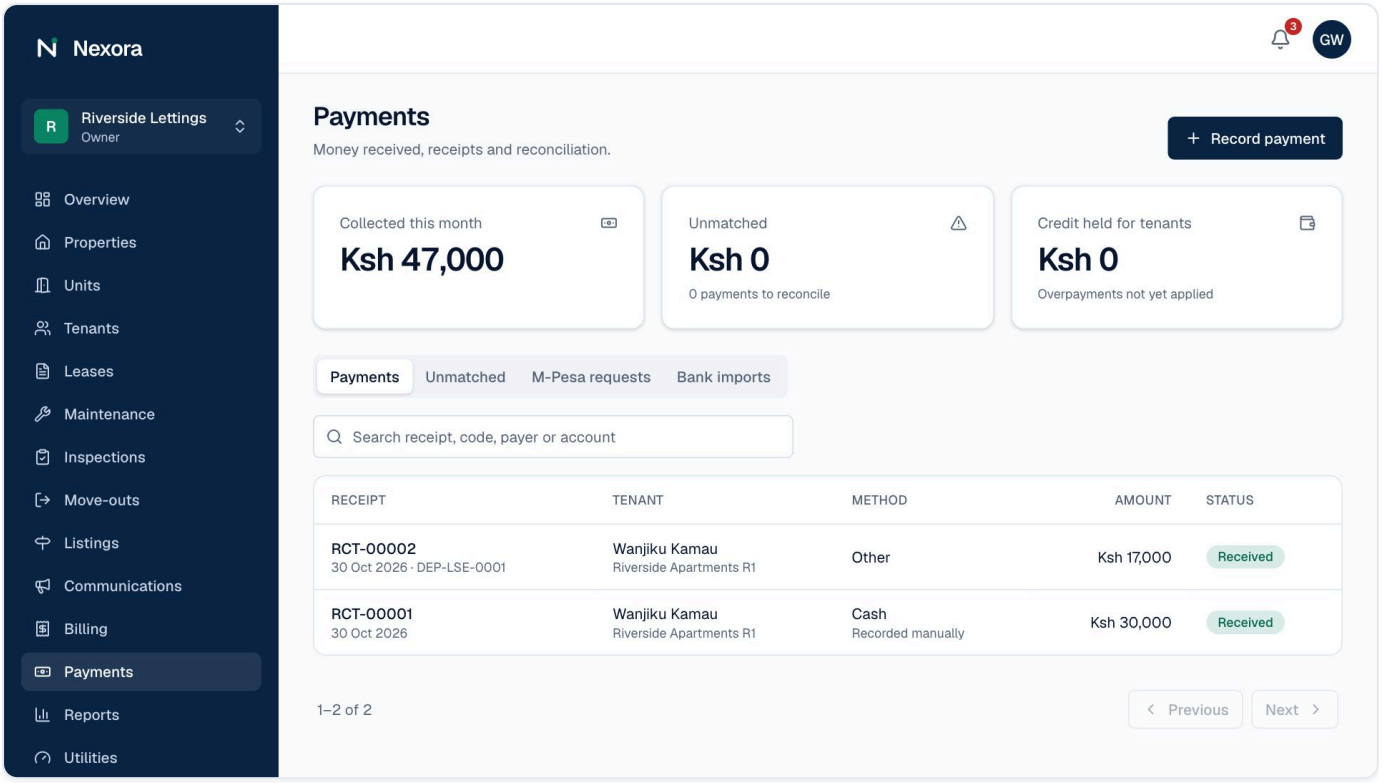
Sidebar → Billing

Generate invoices bills a month for everyone, with a preview first; running a month again only adds what's new. **Invoices** lists every bill with outstanding and overdue filters; open one to see its lines, credit part of it, or void it. **Billing runs** is the history of monthly runs. **Shared costs** splits a bill such as common-area electricity between units. To bill every month without clicking, switch on **Automatic billing** under Charges.



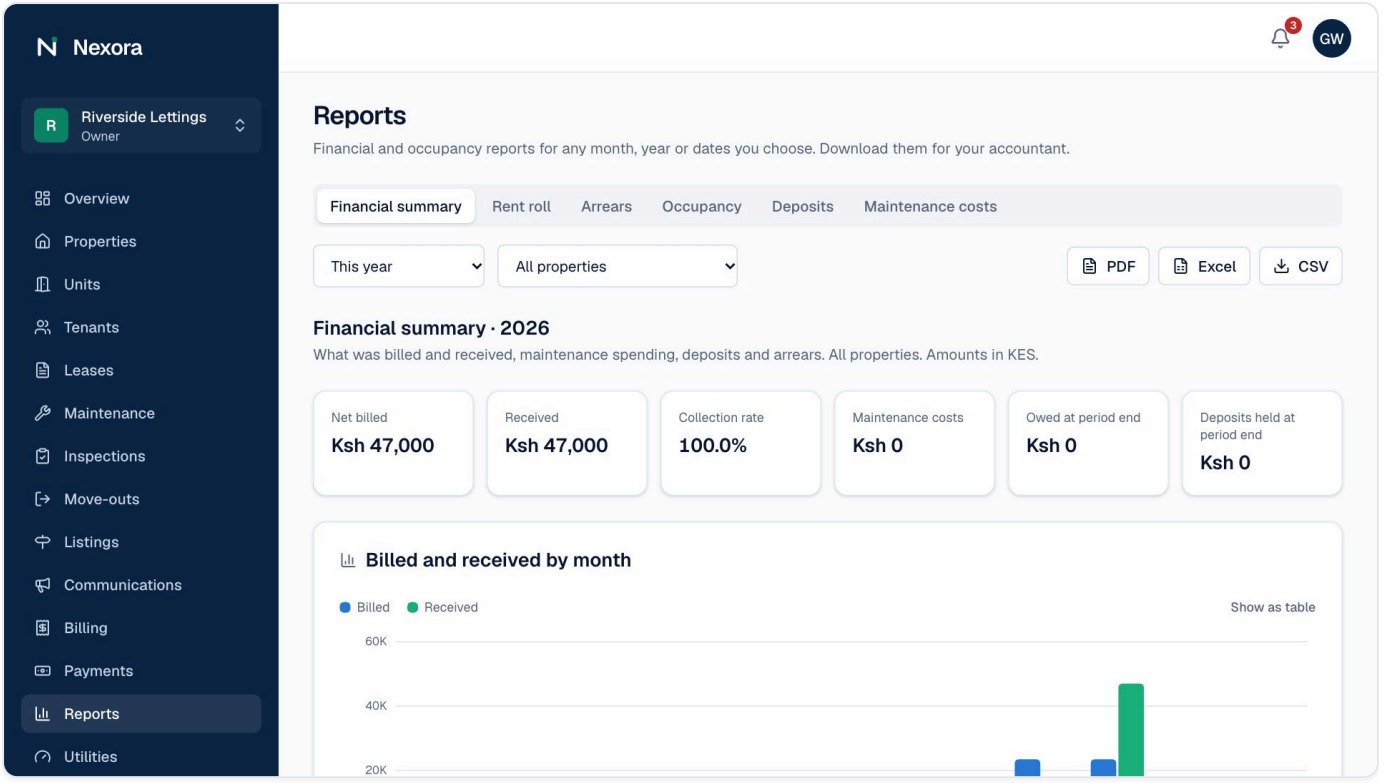
Sidebar → Payments

Money received and receipts. **Record payment** for cash, bank or M-Pesa received outside the system. **Unmatched**: payments that arrived without a recognisable account number; **Match** them to a tenant. **M-Pesa requests**: payment prompts sent to tenants' phones. **Bank imports**: upload a bank statement (CSV) and payments are matched to tenants by reference. Every payment has a printable receipt.



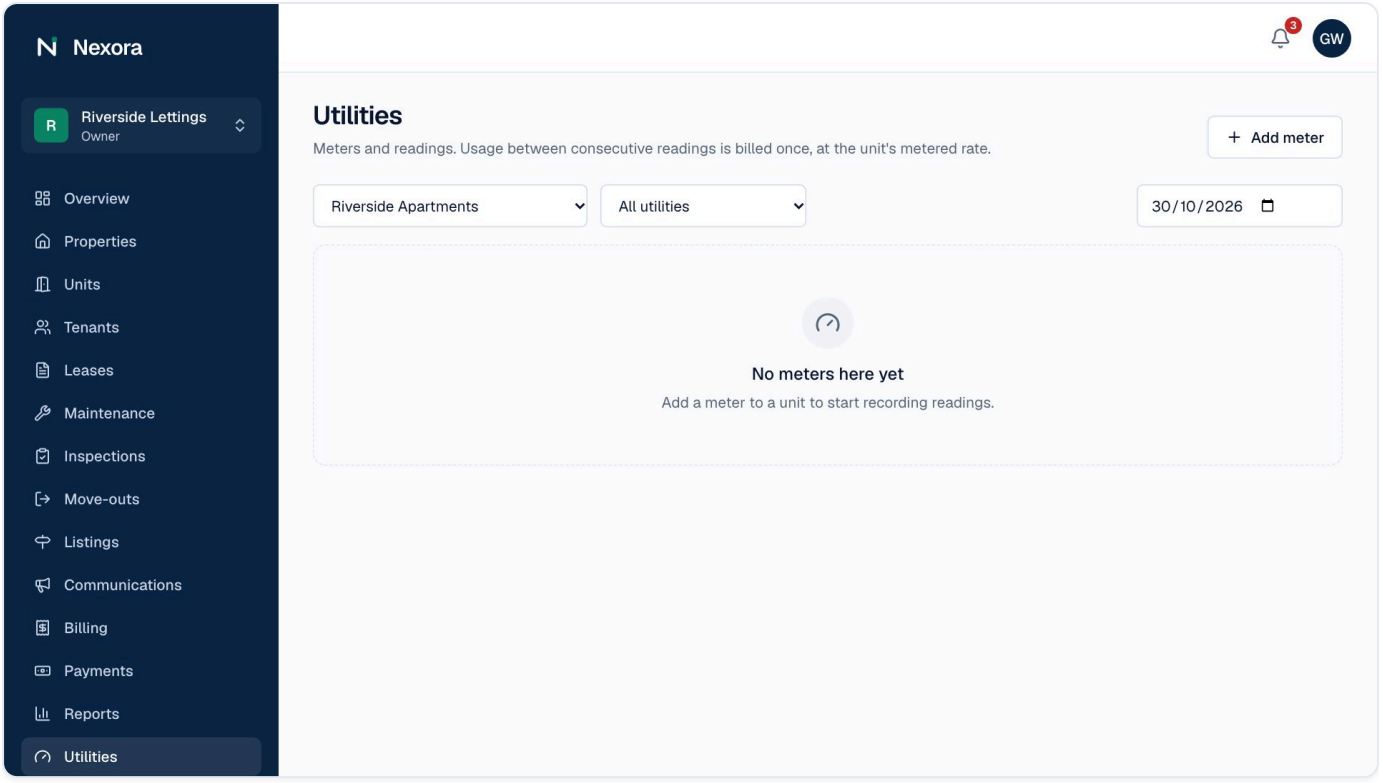
Sidebar → Reports

Reports for any month, year or dates you choose, for one property or all: **Financial summary** (billed by income category, received by payment method, maintenance costs, deposits and arrears, with a month-by-month chart), **Rent roll**, **Arrears** by how long they're overdue, **Occupancy** with vacant units, **Deposits** and **Maintenance costs**. Download any report as **PDF**, **Excel** or **CSV** for your accountant. A month's rent counts in that month even if it was invoiced later.



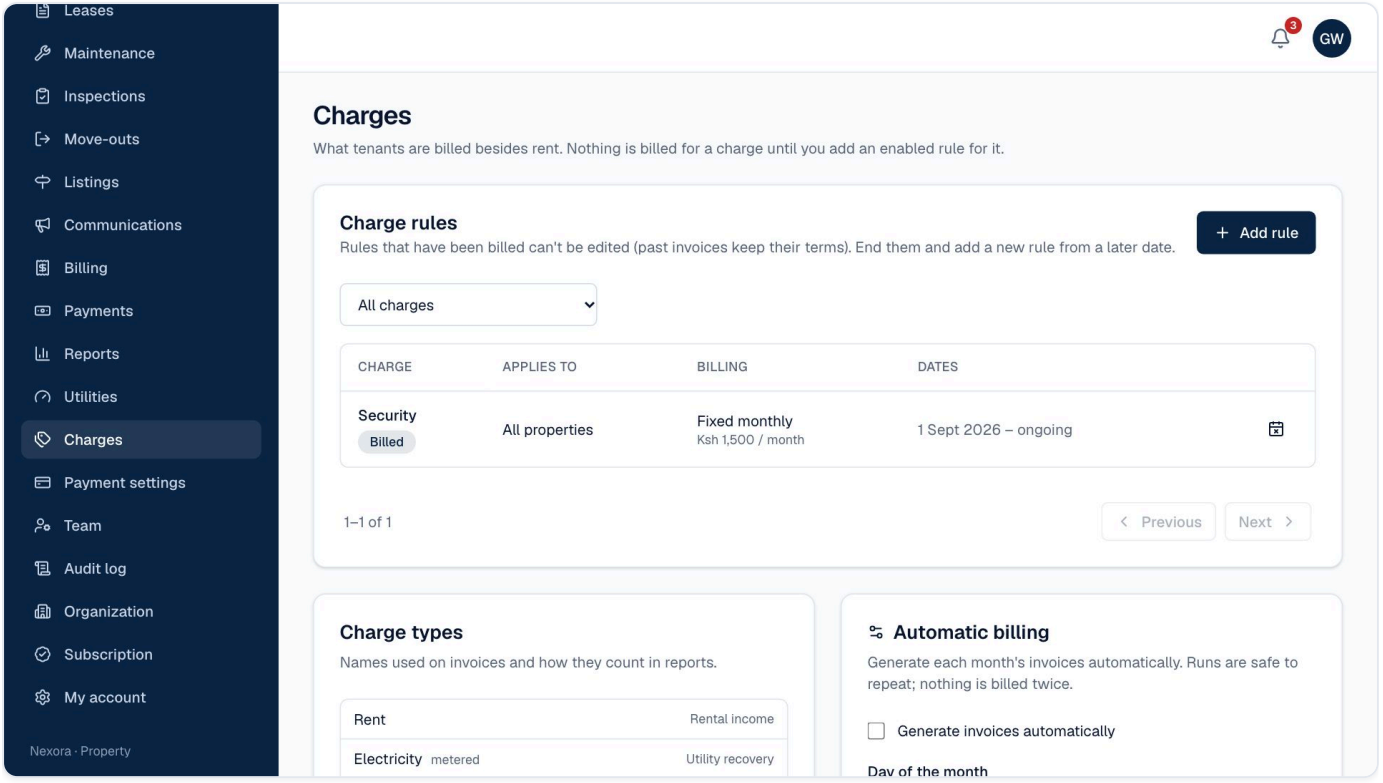
Sidebar → Utilities

Water and electricity meters per unit. Add a meter to a unit, then enter readings for a whole property at once. Usage between two readings is billed once, at the unit's metered rate (set under **Charges**).



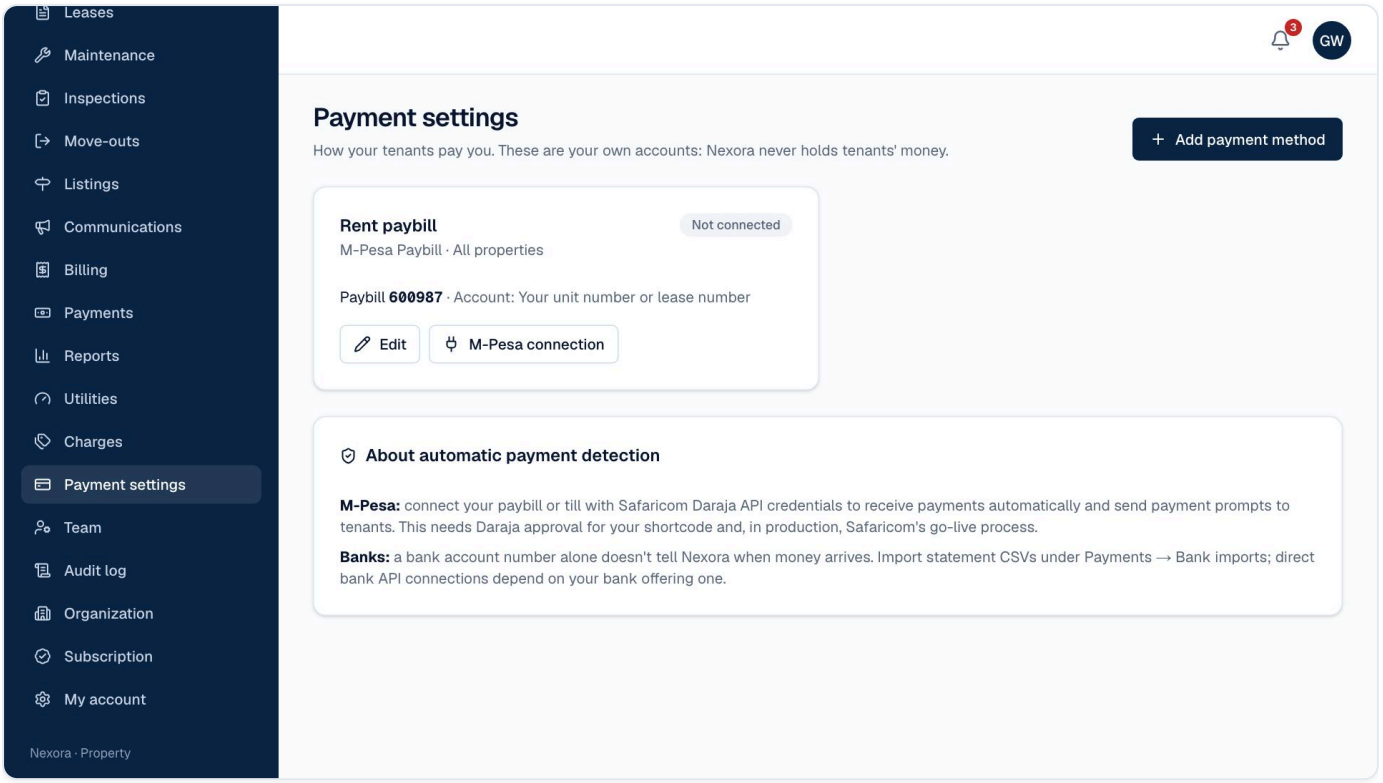
Sidebar → Charges

What tenants pay besides rent: security, garbage, water, parking and so on. **Add rule** sets the amount, how it's billed (fixed monthly, metered, or shared), who it applies to (all properties, a property, a unit type or one unit) and from which date. The most specific rule wins, so you can exempt a unit or charge it differently. Nothing is billed for a charge until it has an enabled rule. **Charge types** are the names used on invoices. **Automatic billing** generates each month's invoices by itself on the day you choose (safe to repeat: nothing is billed twice).



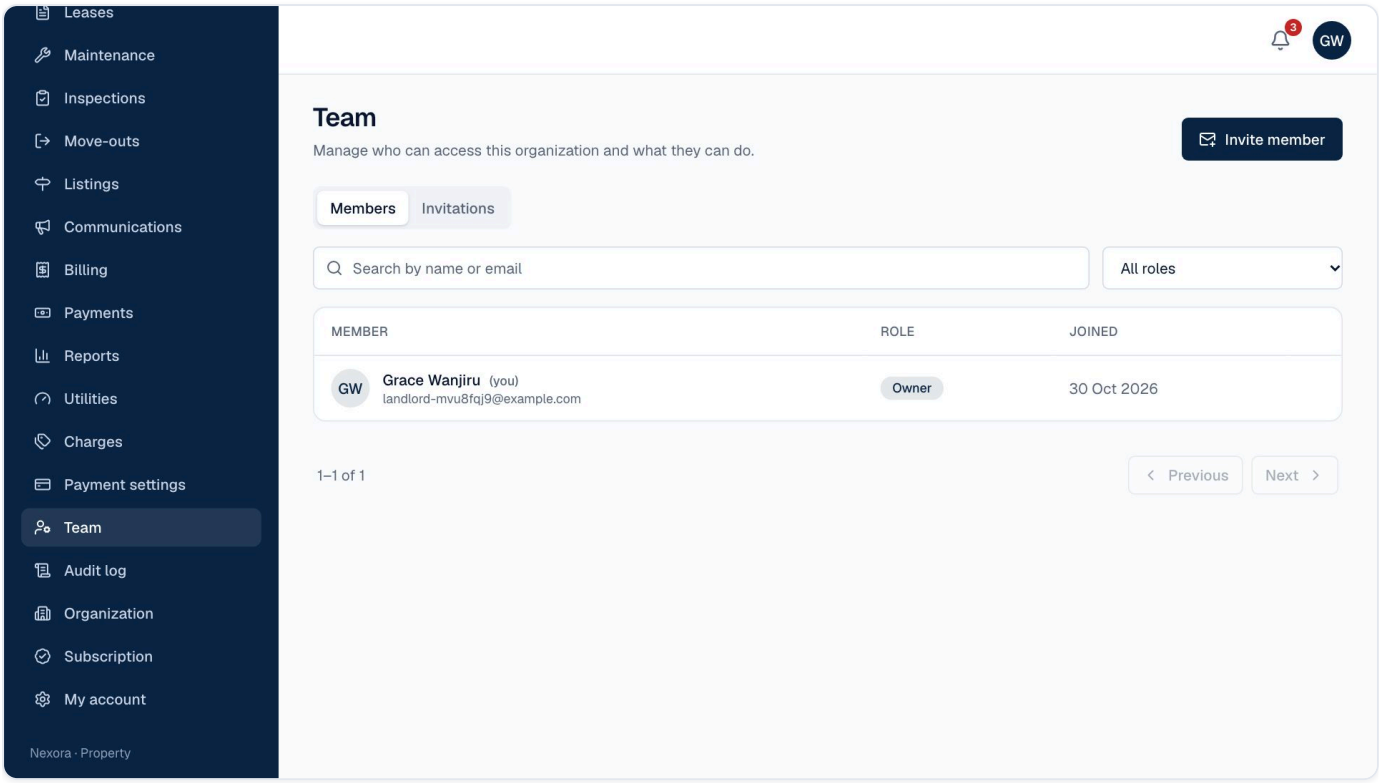
Sidebar → Payment settings

How tenants pay you: M-Pesa paybill or till, bank account, or cash, for all properties or one property. These are your own accounts; Nexora never holds tenants' money. Connecting M-Pesa (Daraja) lets payments match tenants automatically and lets tenants get a payment prompt on their phone.



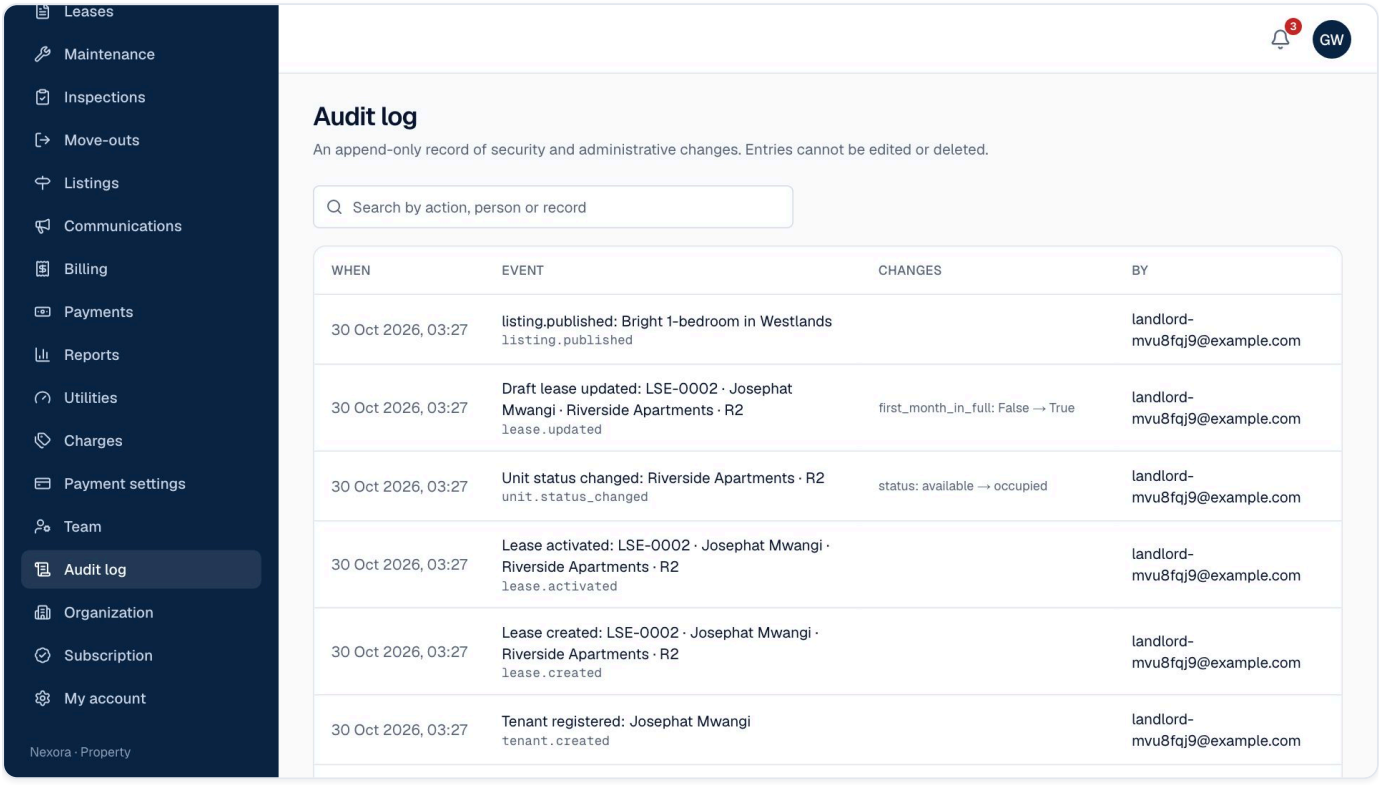
Sidebar → Team

Who can work in your organization. **Members**: each person's role (Owner, Property manager, Accountant, Caretaker), and **Edit access** to grant or remove individual permissions and assign properties. **Invitations**: invite someone by email and see pending invitations.



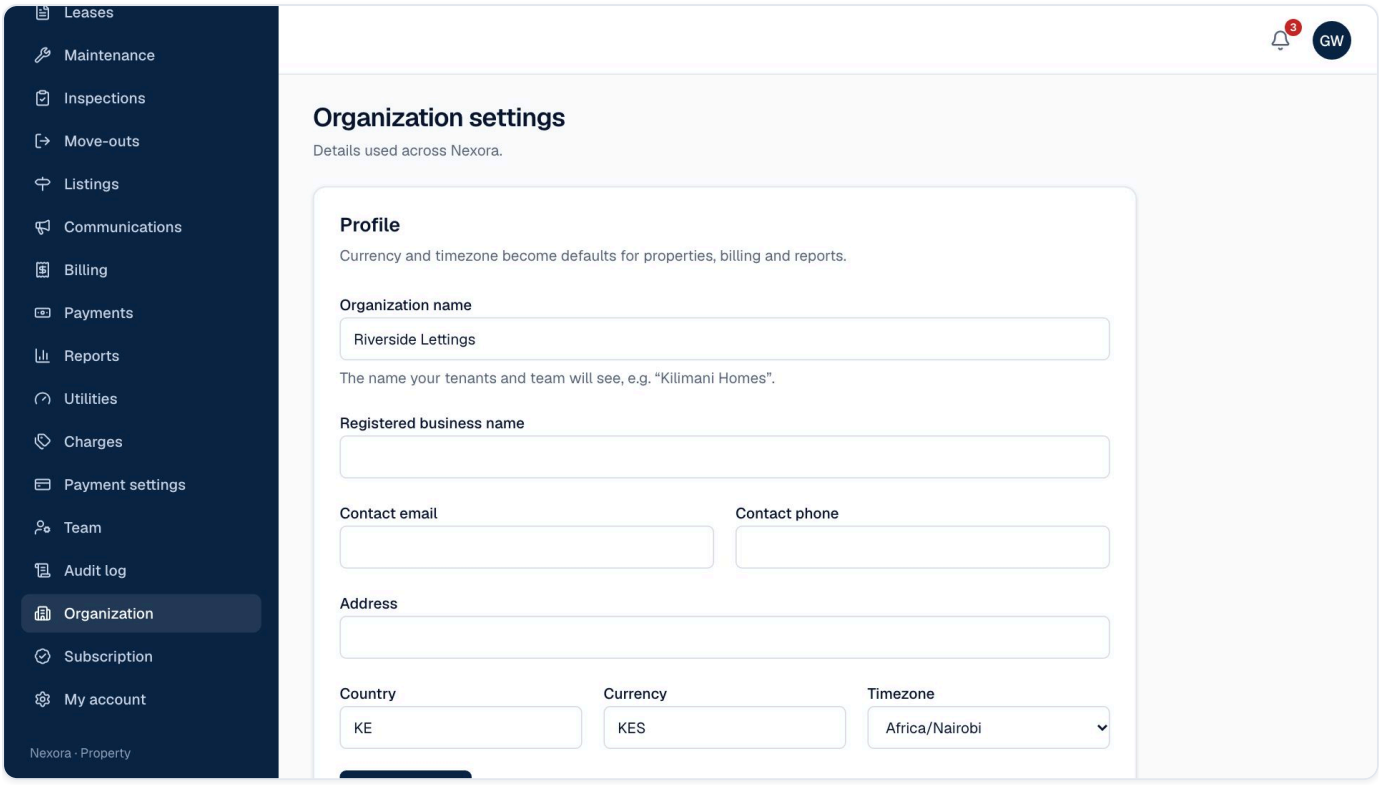
Sidebar → Audit log

A permanent record of every change: who did what and when, including actions tenants take in the app. Search it by action, person or record. Entries can't be edited or deleted.



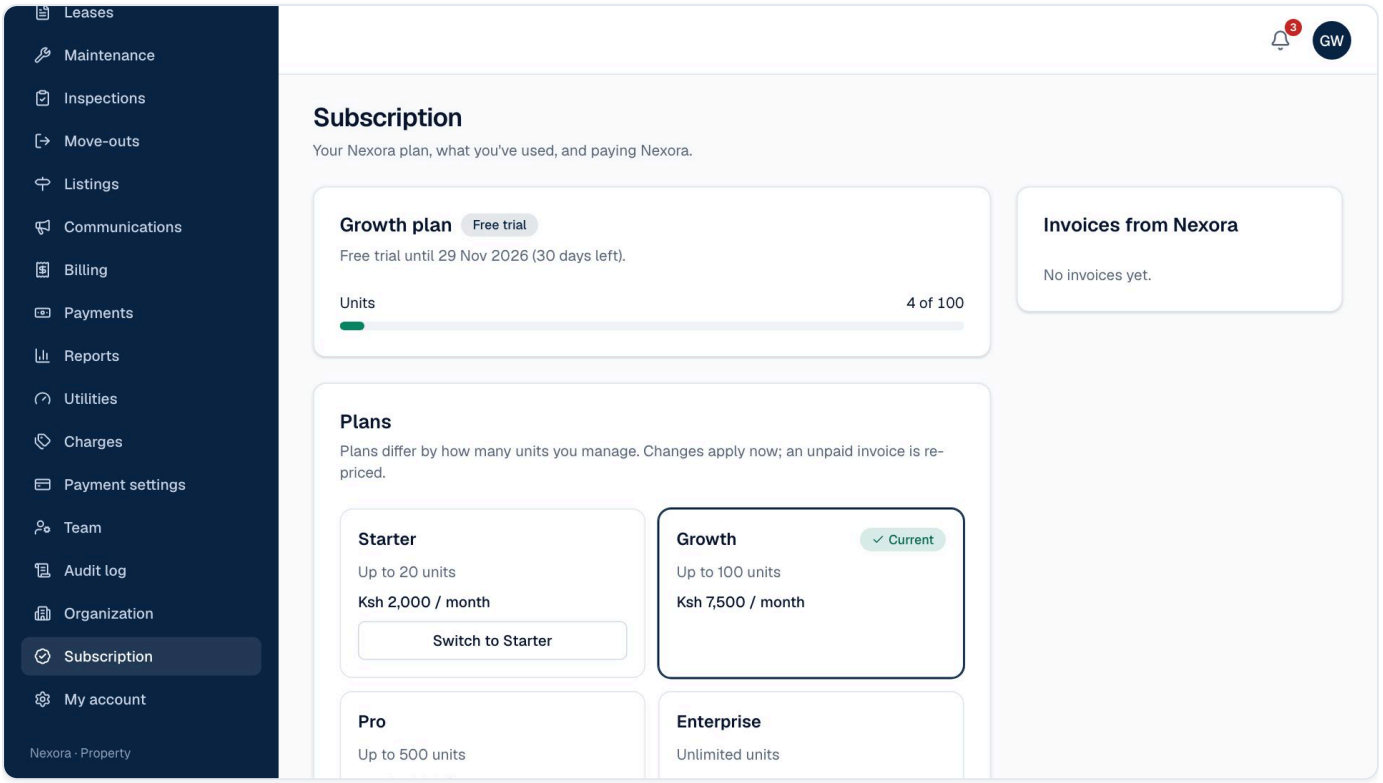
Sidebar → Organization

Your organization's details: name, legal name, contact phone and email (shown to tenants on receipts and in the tenant app), address, country, currency and time zone.



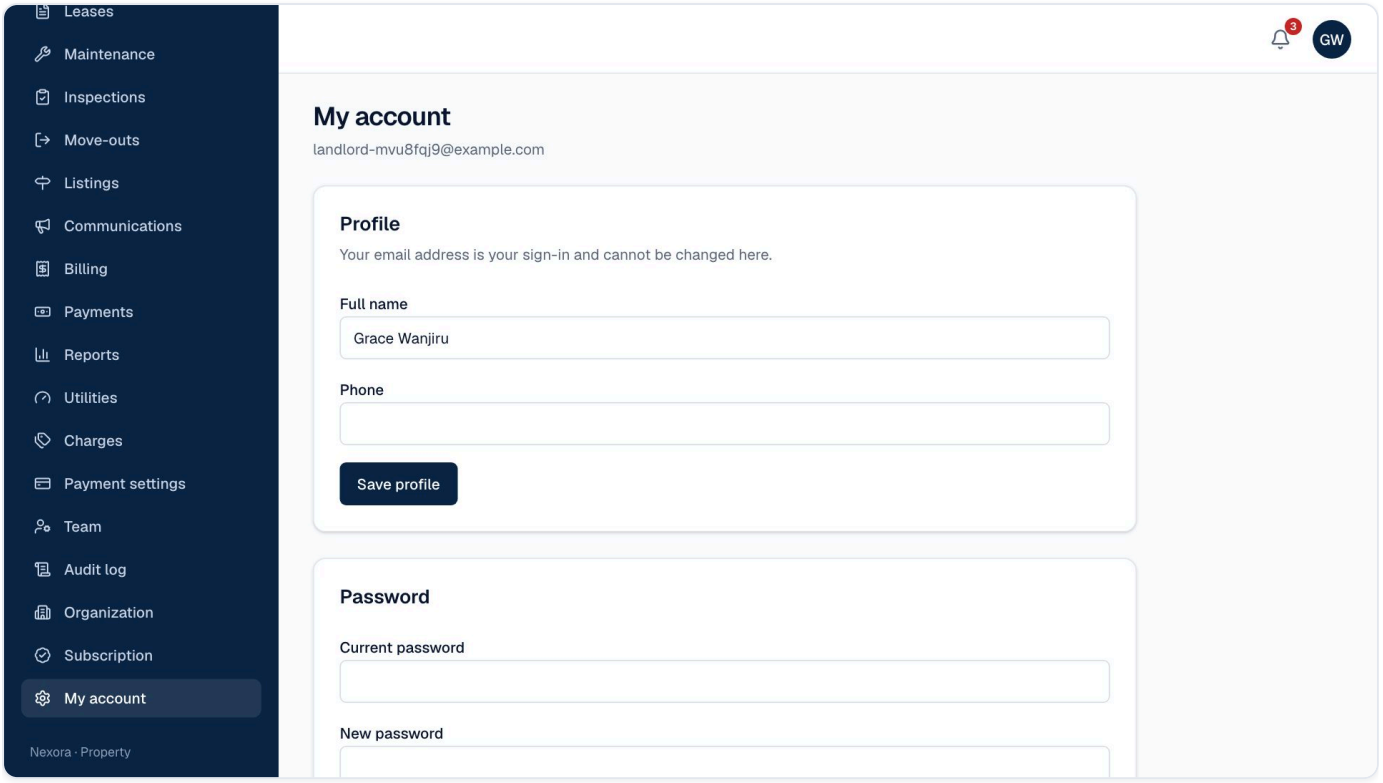
Sidebar → Subscription

Owners only. Your Nexora plan and how many units it allows, the units you use, and Nexora's invoices to you. A new organization starts with a 30-day free trial. A week before it ends you get an invoice: pay it with an M-Pesa prompt to your phone, or to Nexora's paybill or bank account with the account number shown. **Switch to** another plan at any time; a smaller plan must still fit your units. If an invoice stays unpaid, a banner warns you, and 14 days after access ends Nexora becomes **read-only** (you can still see and download everything) until it's paid.



Sidebar → My account

Your own name, phone and password.

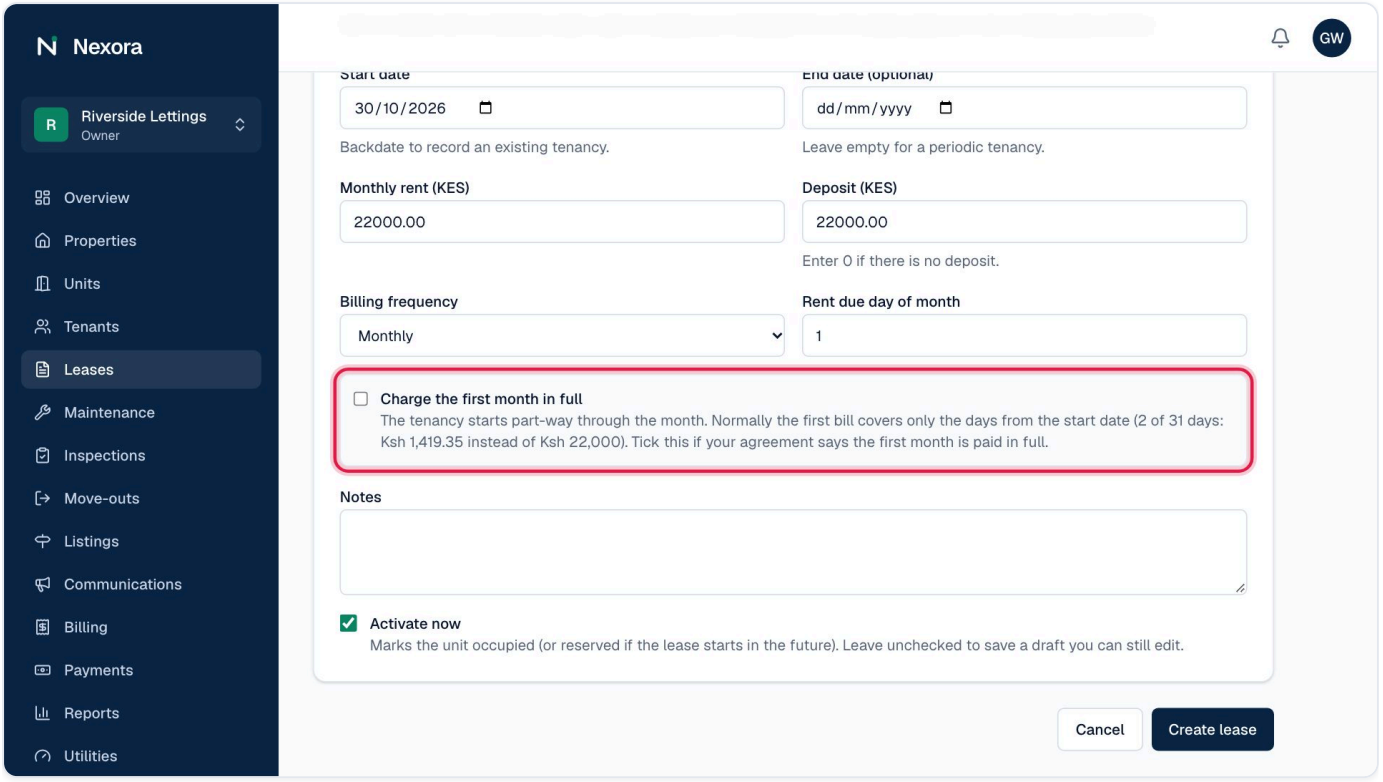


14 Tenants moving in mid-month

By default, a tenant who moves in part-way through a month pays only for the days they're there: rent 13,000 from the 29th of a 31-day month bills 3 days, Ksh 1,258.06. If your agreement says the first month is paid in full, switch this on.

47 **LANDLORD**

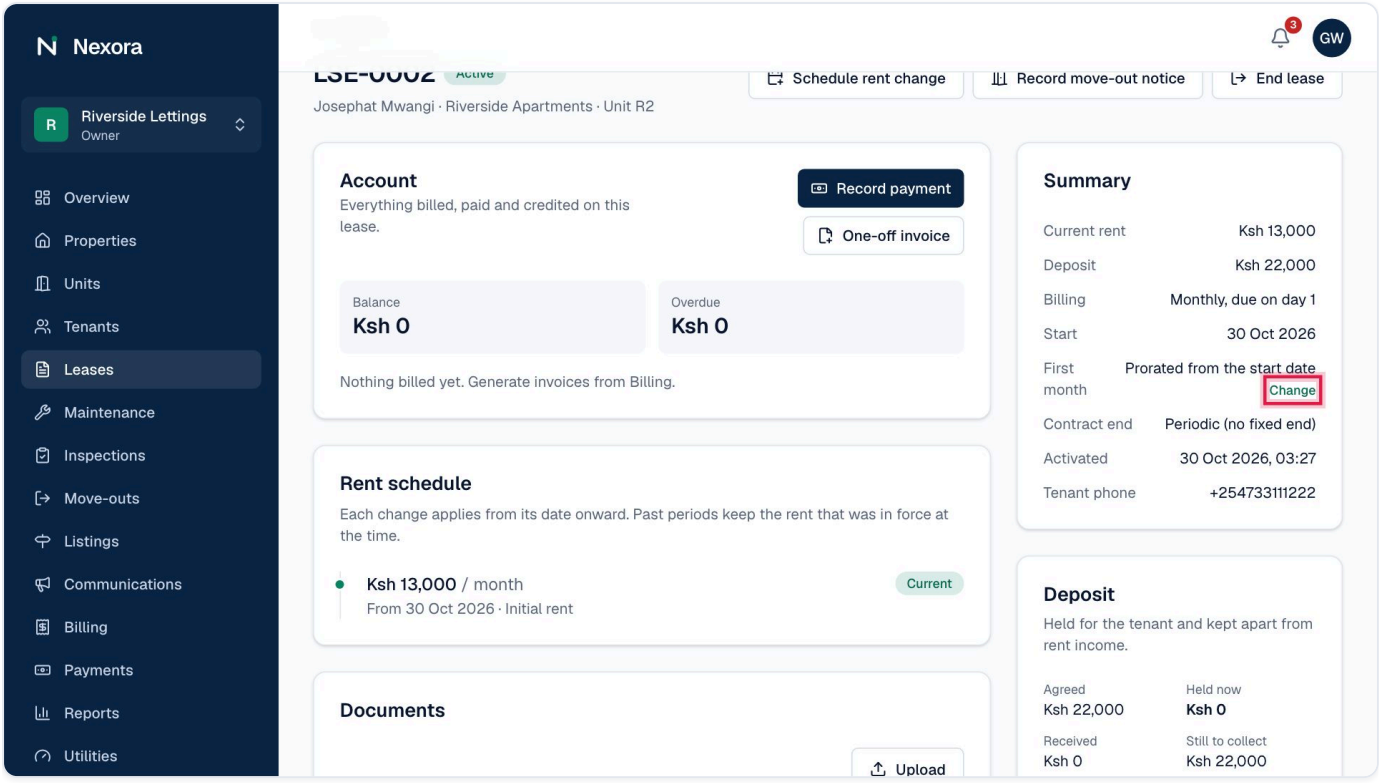
On a new lease: when the start date isn't the 1st, the form shows **Charge the first month in full**, with both amounts so you can compare. Tick it before **Create lease**.

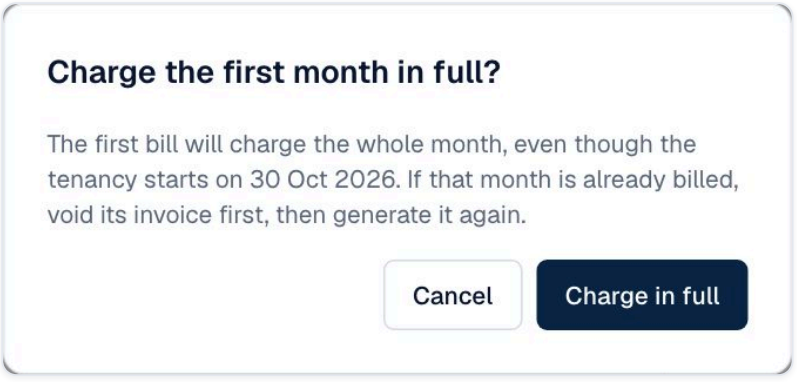


48 LANDLORD

On an existing lease: the summary shows **First month: Prorated from the start date**. Click **Change** and confirm.

> **Already billed the first month prorated?** Open that invoice and **Void** it, switch the option on the lease, then **Generate invoices** for that month again. The option can't be changed while the first month is on an issued invoice.





49 **LANDLORD**

The bill now charges the whole month, marked *(first month charged in full)*. Fixed monthly charges such as security are charged in full too. Later months are billed as normal.

